Hart
DISTRICT COUNCIL

Hart's Housing Service Evidence Base - 2011

"Helping local people find housing solutions"

Last updated **03/08/2011**

www.hart.gov.uk

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Purpose of this document

The table below shows the Housing Strategy and its related sub-strategies involved in the delivery plan for the service. This document - Hart's Housing Service Evidence Base - forms a key part of the foundations for the strategic plans of the service.

Housing Strategy	**www.hart.gov.uk/hs-hs2011-14.pdf**
Preventing Homelessness Strategy	www.hart.gov.uk/hs-phs2011-14.pdf
Private Sector Housing Strategy	www.hart.gov.uk/hs-pshs2011-14.pdf
Older Persons Housing Strategy	www.hart.gov.uk/hs-ophs2011-14.pdf
Rural Housing Strategy	www.hart.gov.uk/hs-rhs2011-14.pdf

A number of other sources should also be considered alongside this document in terms of the evidence based used to inform the Housing Strategy. Among these, the key sources are:

- **Housing Strategy Statistical Appendix**
- **Local Development Framework (LDF)**
- **Hart's LDF Annual Monitoring Report**
- **House Condition Survey**
- **P1E - Local Authority activity under homelessness provisions of the 1996 Housing Act – Returns**
- **NOMIS Official Labour Market Statistics**
- **Hart, Rushmoor and Surrey Heath joint Strategic Housing Market Assessment**
- **Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update – June 2010**
- **CORE Annual Reports - Hart**

Section 1: **Housing profile of the district**

This section provides background information on the number and tenure of houses in the district as well as looking at the condition and level of vacancies of this stock.

1.1 Profile of the housing stock in Hart

Hart district has **36,508** dwellings as at the 31st of March 2011. Of this, 80% is owner occupied, compared to the national average of 70%. The private rented stock at 9% is lower than the national average. There is also fewer shared households with less than 10% of the national average. There are also 5 park homes sites (300 homes) and 2 permanent gypsy and traveller sites (40 homes).

Source: House Condition Survey, HSSA 2011

Number of dwellings by tenure in Hart

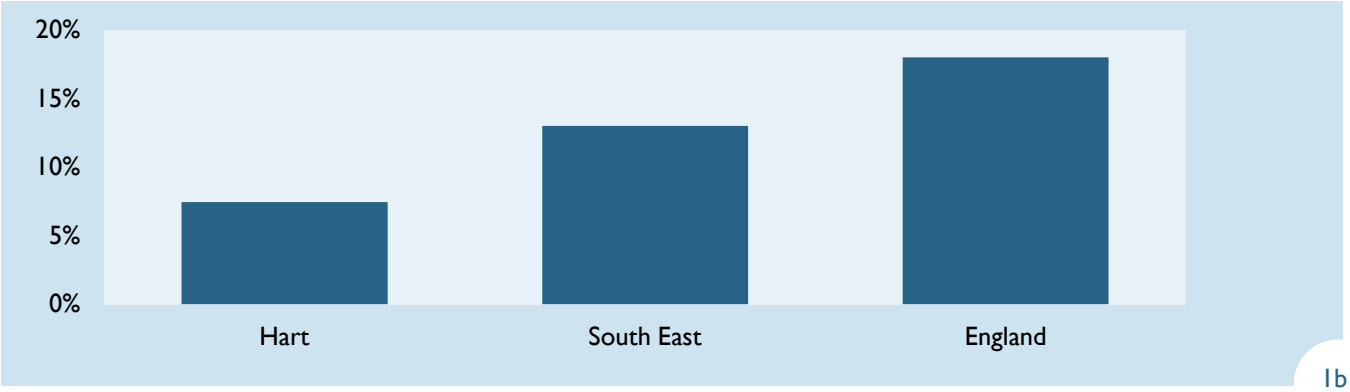
1a

Source: HSSA 2011

1.2 Amount of affordable housing in Hart compared to others

Hart district currently has one of the lowest percentages of social rented housing stock in England; at around 7% it is significantly lower than both the national average (18%) and the average for the South East (13%).

Social rented housing stock as a percentage in Hart, the South East and England

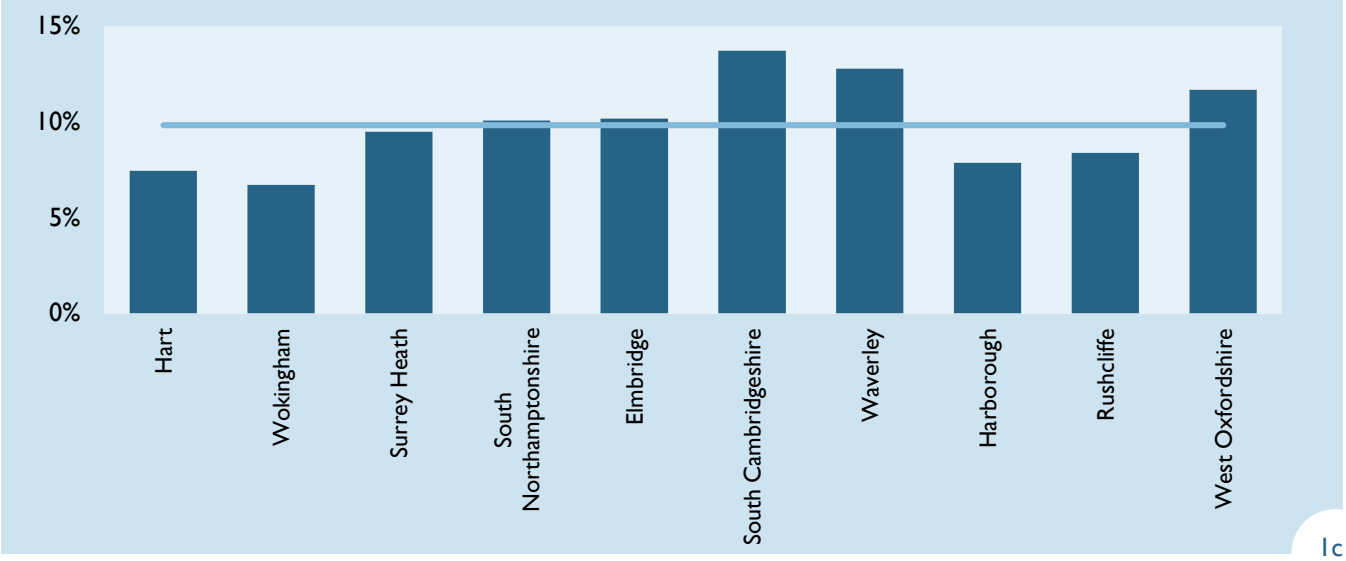


1b

Source: CLG live tables (100) 2010

Whilst Hart was ranked as the least deprived district in England in 2010, it also had a lower percentage of rented affordable housing than all but one of the ten least deprived local authorities (average shown on chart below at 10%).

Social rented housing stock as a percentage for ten least deprived local authorities

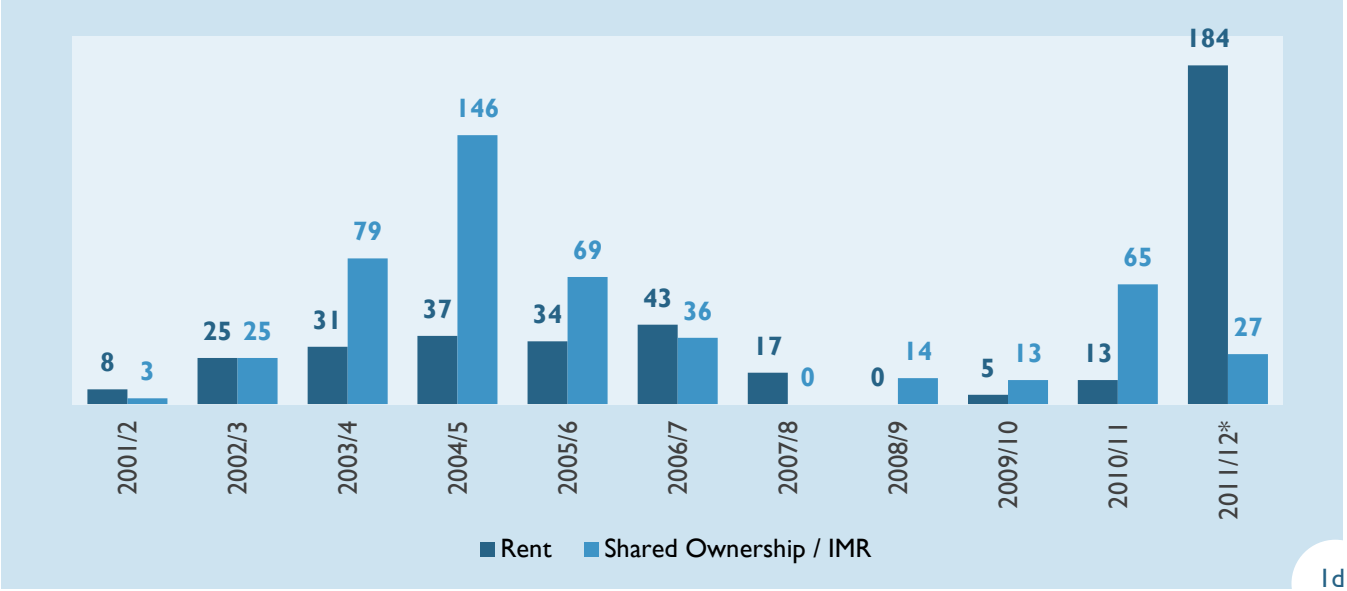


Source: CLG live tables (100), IMD 2010

1.3 Delivery of affordable housing in Hart

The chart below shows the trend in delivery of new affordable housing through new build and acquisitions. As can be see there was a period of low delivery between 2007/08 and the end of 2009/10. However 2010/11 delivered 78 properties and 2011/12 is expected to produce a very high level of new properties including a large scheme of 74 units providing the first major Extra Care (housing with care and support facilities for older people) accommodation scheme for Hart.

Number of number of affordable homes provided in each year through new build and acquisitions by tenure in Hart



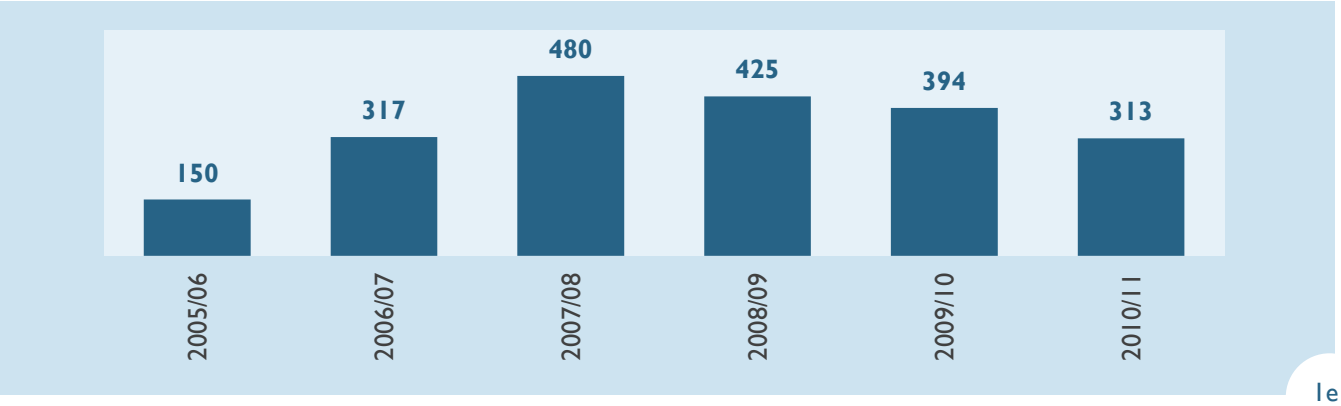
Source: Housing Service Statistics / NI155 (2011)

1.4 Empty homes and stock condition in Hart

The number of empty dwellings in Hart that have been vacant for more than six months has been steadily decreasing since 2007/08. 84% of Hart's private housing stock has been built since 1945 and is dominated by houses and bungalows. The state of repair of homes in Hart is significantly better than the national average, with 18% of the privately owned stock failing the decent homes standard compared to 35.8% nationally.

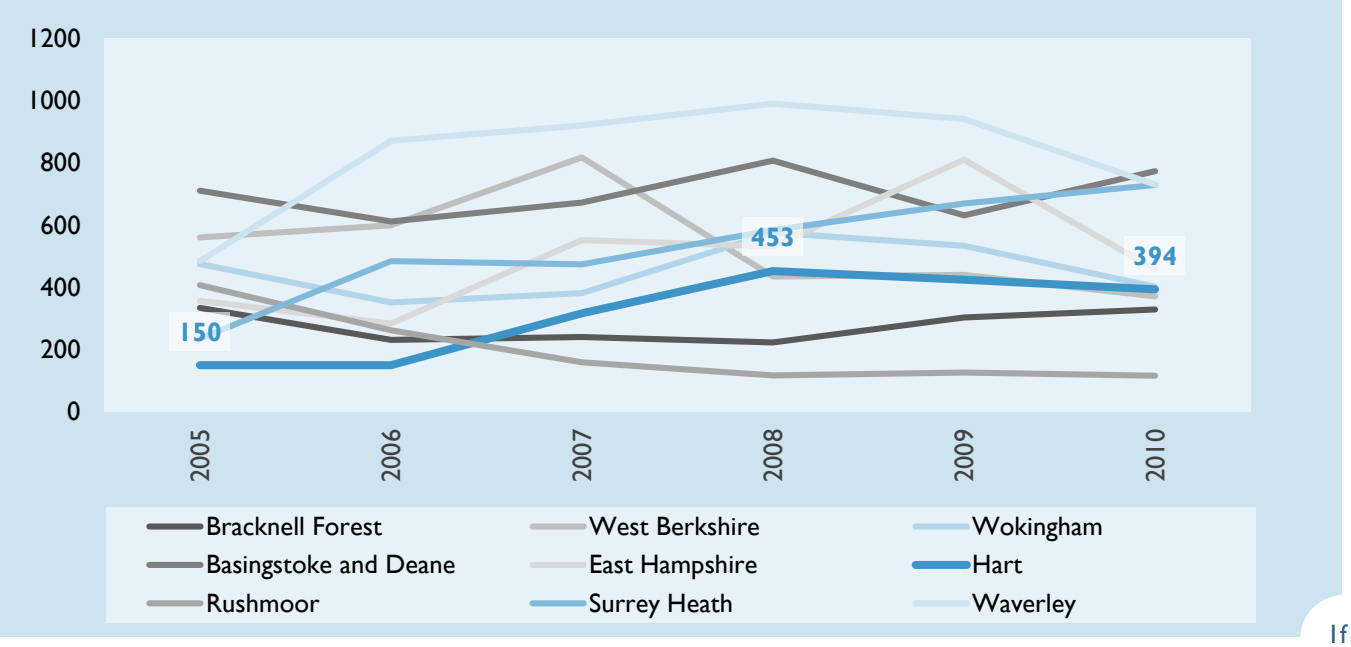
Source: House Condition Survey, HSSA 2011

Number of dwellings in Hart vacant for over 6 months



Source: HSSA 2011

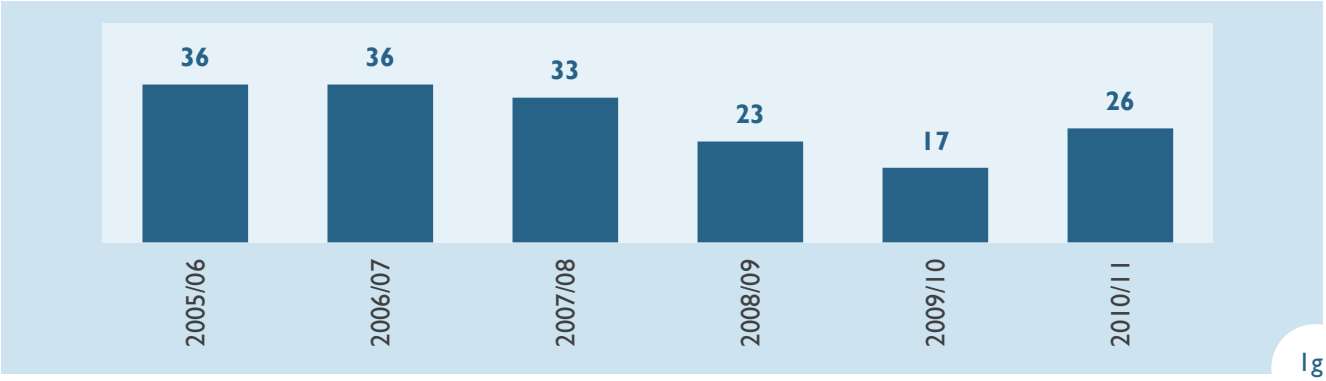
Number of private sector dwellings vacant for over 6 months in Hart and neighbouring authorities



Source: Homes and Communities Agency 2011

The House Condition Survey commissioned by Hart and completed at the end of 2010 suggests that there are **3,340** dwellings in the district with category 1 hazards (based on the Housing Heath and Safety Rating System (HHSRS).

Number of renewal assistance works undertaken on private sector dwellings in Hart



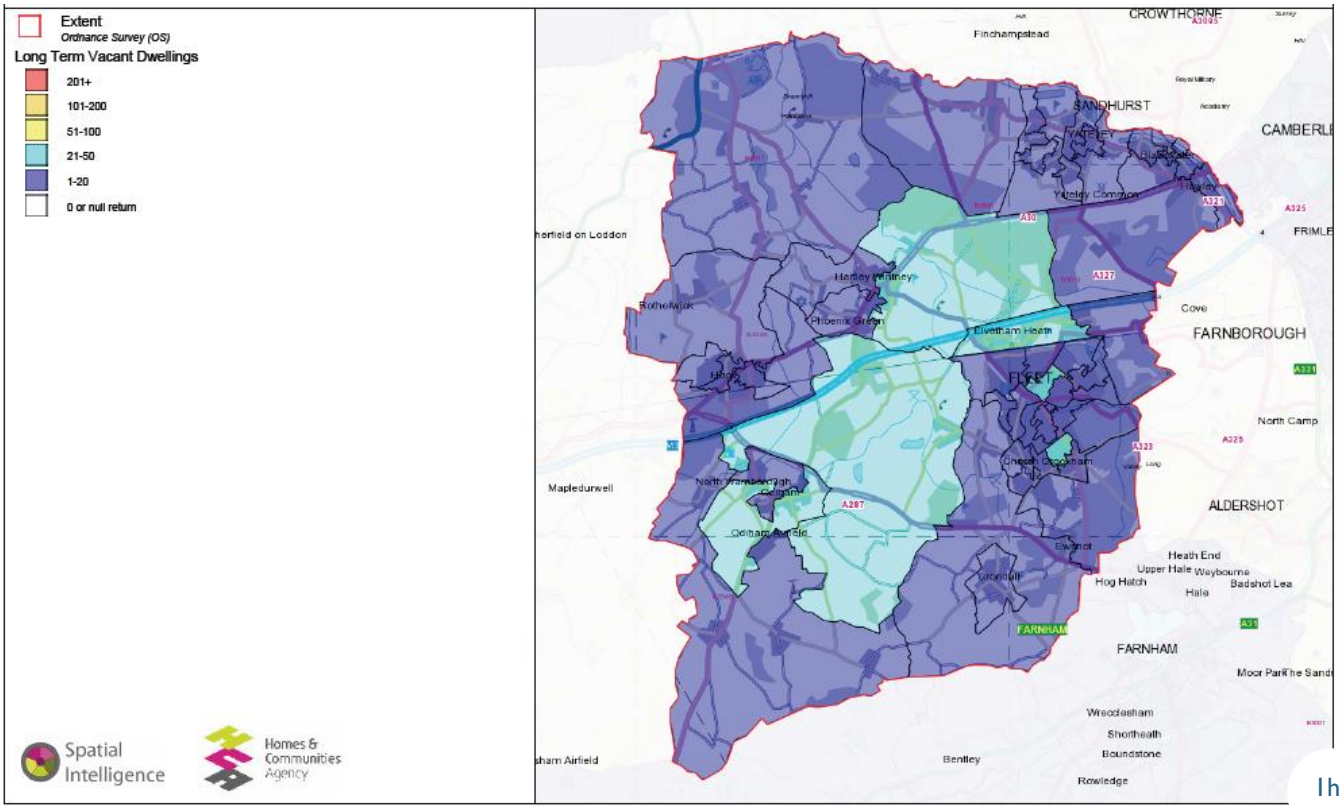
Ig

Source: HSSA 2011

1.5 Location of empty homes in Hart

Whilst the number of empty dwellings in Hart is relatively low but there is some variation in terms of the spread of empty properties across the district. The figures below are measured at the Lower Super Output Area (LSOA), a measure that is smaller than wards or parishes and based on population size used by the Office for National Statistics in their Neighbourhood Statistics.

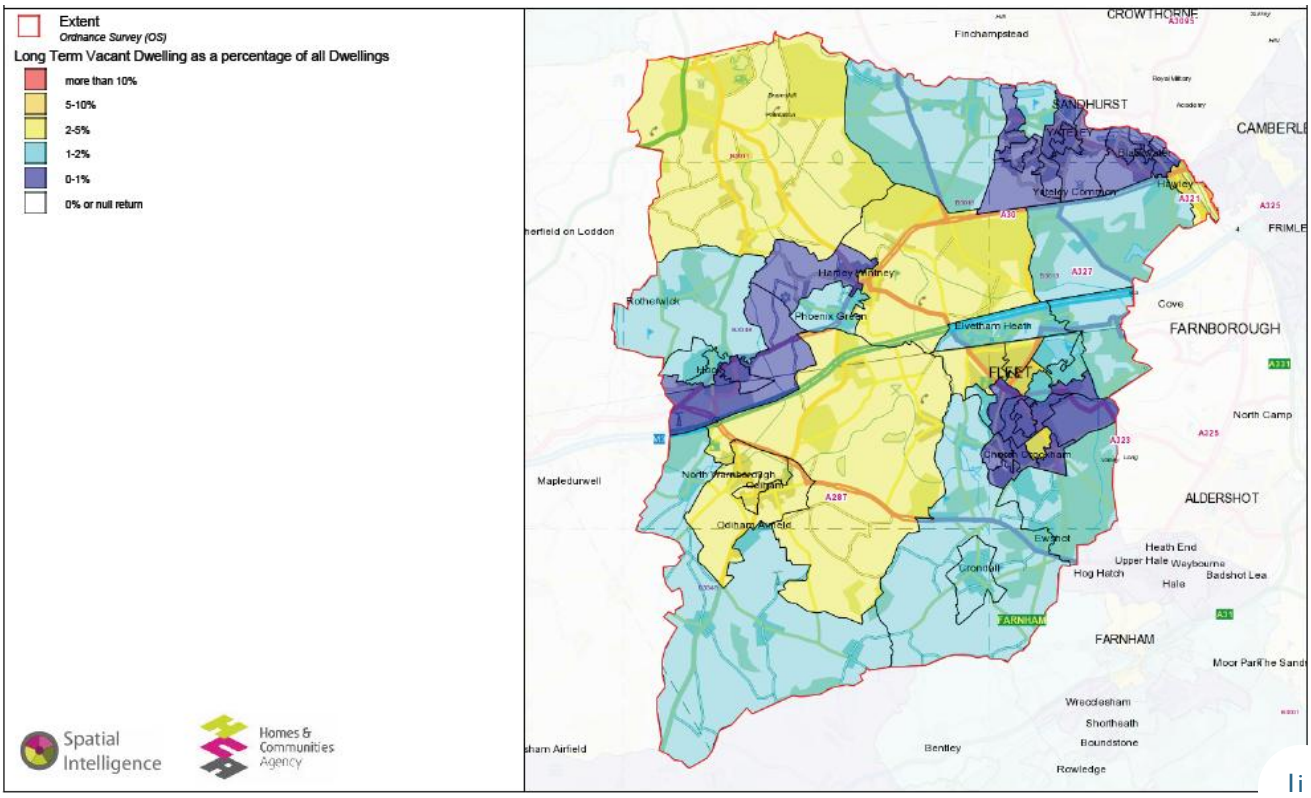
Number of dwellings in Hart vacant for over 6 months by Lower Super Output Area



Ih

Source: Homes and Communities Agency 2011

Percentage of dwellings in Hart vacant for over 6 months by Lower Super Output Area



Source: Homes and Communities Agency 2011

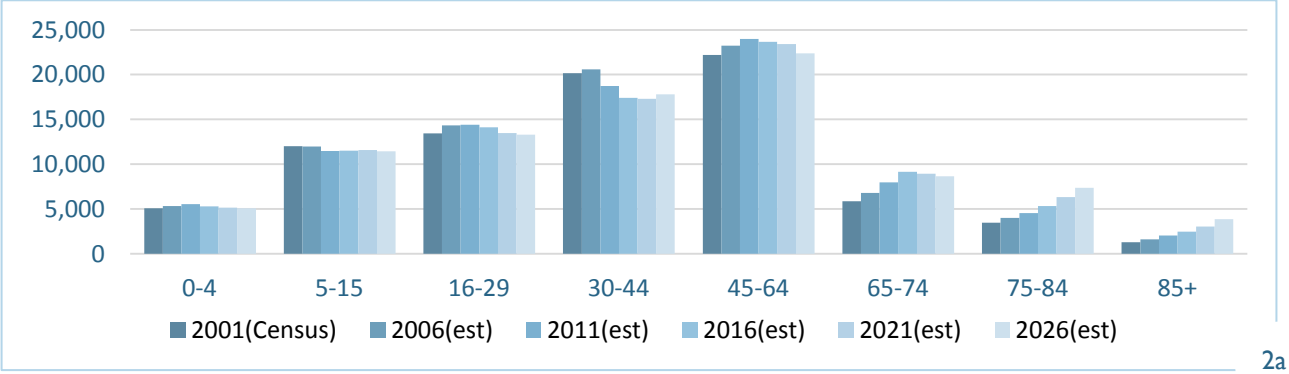
Section 2: **Social and demographic profile of the district**

This section focuses on the population of Hart. It provides information on the age and household profile as well as some other indicators that may impact on the housing stock in Hart including; Income, fuel poverty and crime.

2.1 Age profile of residents in Hart

As can been seen below, the largest numbers of people in Hart are in the 30-44 year old and 45-64 year old age groups. However, the district is projected to experience the greatest percentage change in Hampshire; in the both the 75 - 84 year old and 85+ year old sub-sets of their population, with a 112% and 201% increase respectively between 2001 and 2026. In comparison the 30-44 year old and 45-64 year old age groups are projected to fall by 12 % and rise by 1% respectively. None of the age groups below the 45-64 year old group are expected to experience a positive percentage increase in numbers.

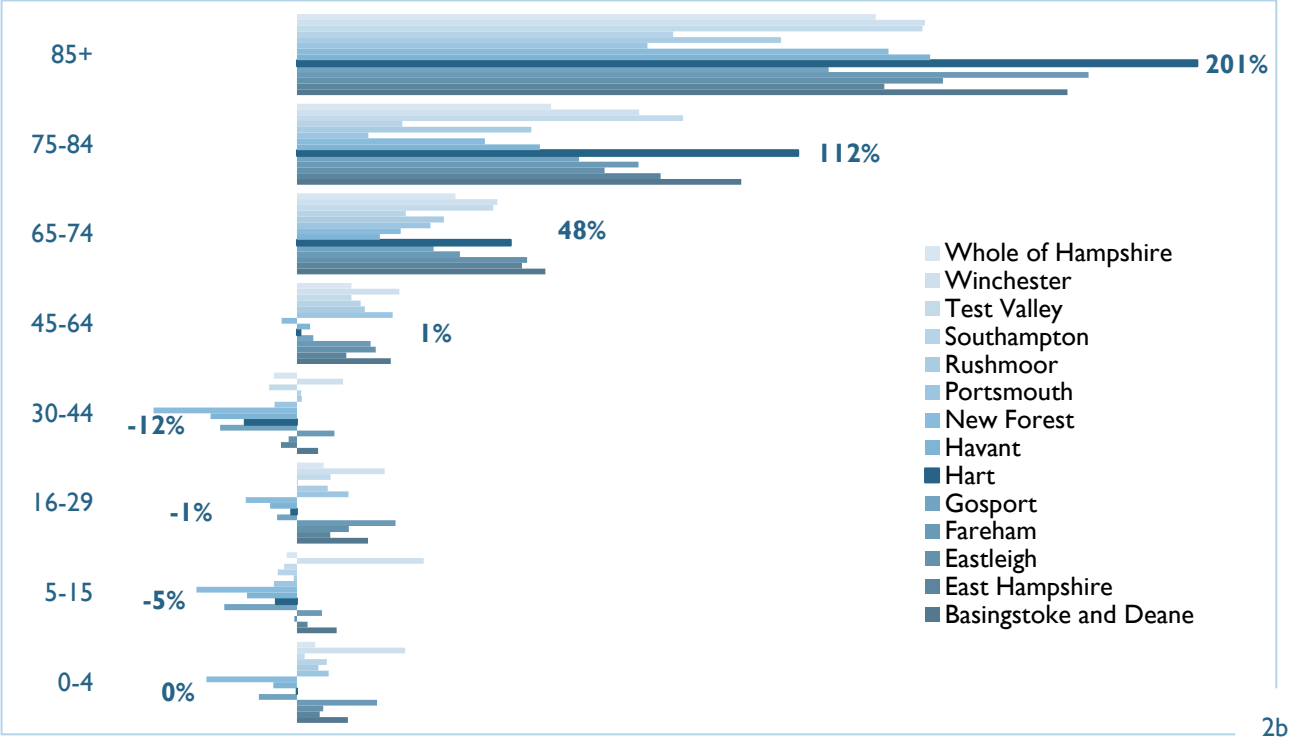
Age profile of Hart district's population and projections to 2026



2a

Source: Hampshire population data 2009

Percentage change in age groups between 2001 and 2026 across Hampshire



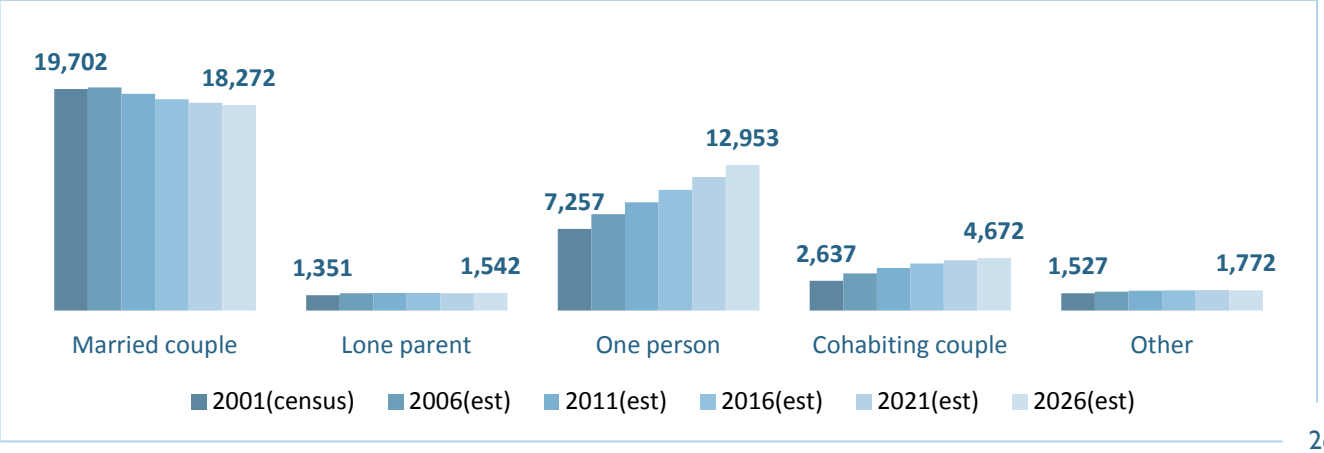
2b

Source: Hampshire population data 2009

2.2 Household profile of residents in Hart

Possibly linked to the trends seen in the age profile, the household composition forecasts suggest that the greatest increase from 2001 to 2026 will be in one person households suggesting an increase in demand for smaller units of accommodation.

Household composition of Hart and projections to 2026



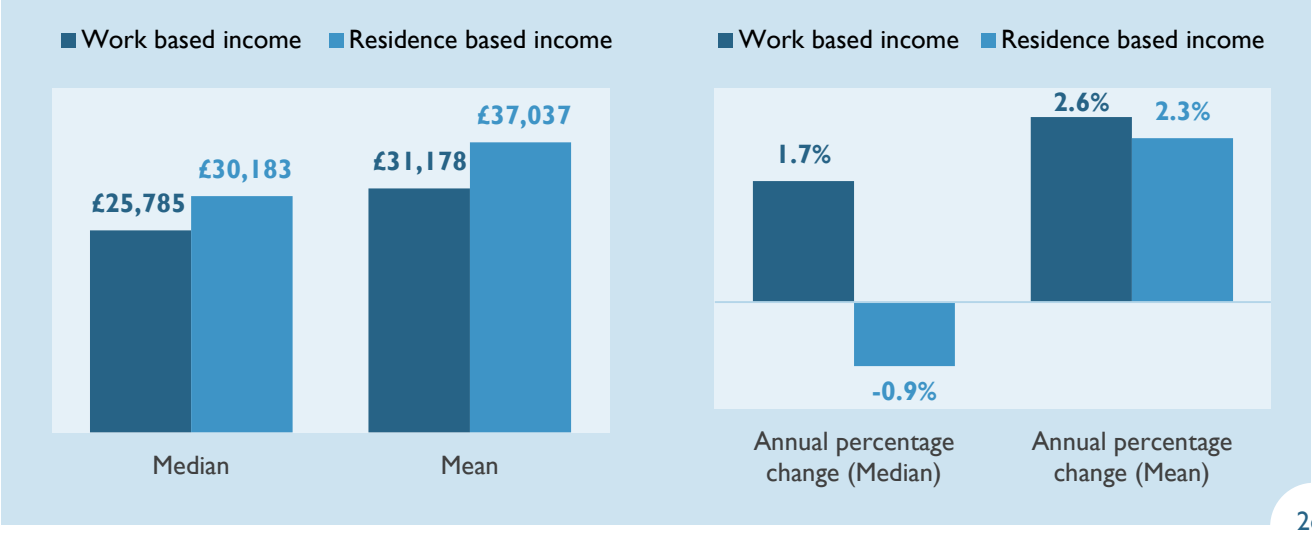
2c

Source: Hampshire population data 2009

2.3 Income levels of residents in Hart

Hart remains a largely affluent area ranking amongst the highest earners (both mean and median) for work placed and residence based income in Hampshire. This high median income level may partly cause higher housing costs up both for purchase and rent, and can price out those on lower incomes and limiting their housing choices. The large difference between average incomes for the population in Hart as a whole against the population of new housing association tenants reflects this. Those households in receipt of income support tend to be found in the more urban centres of the district rather than rural areas where the affordability gap is even more extreme.

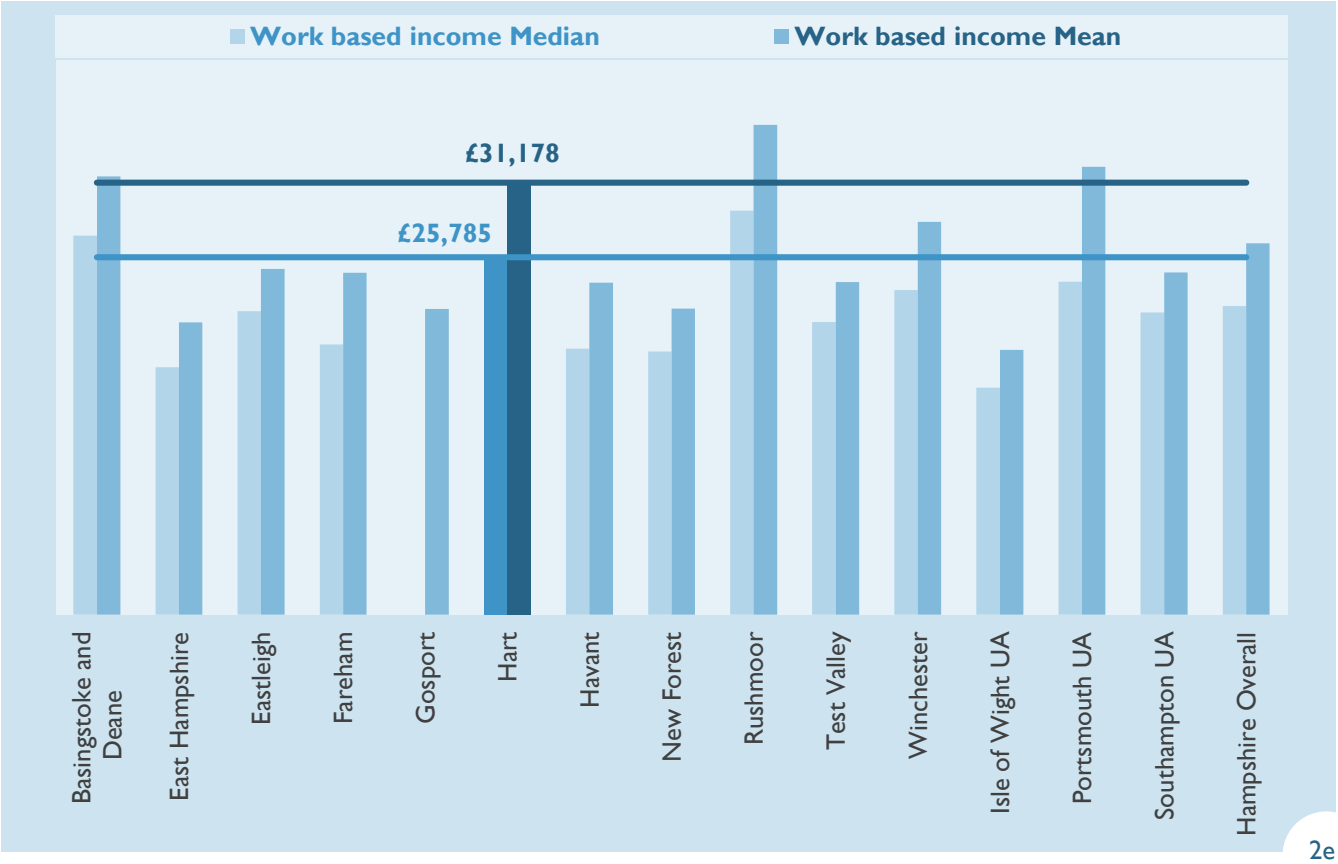
Income levels for Hart district (work based and residence based) 2010



2d

Source: NOMIS / ONS annual survey of hours and earnings 2010

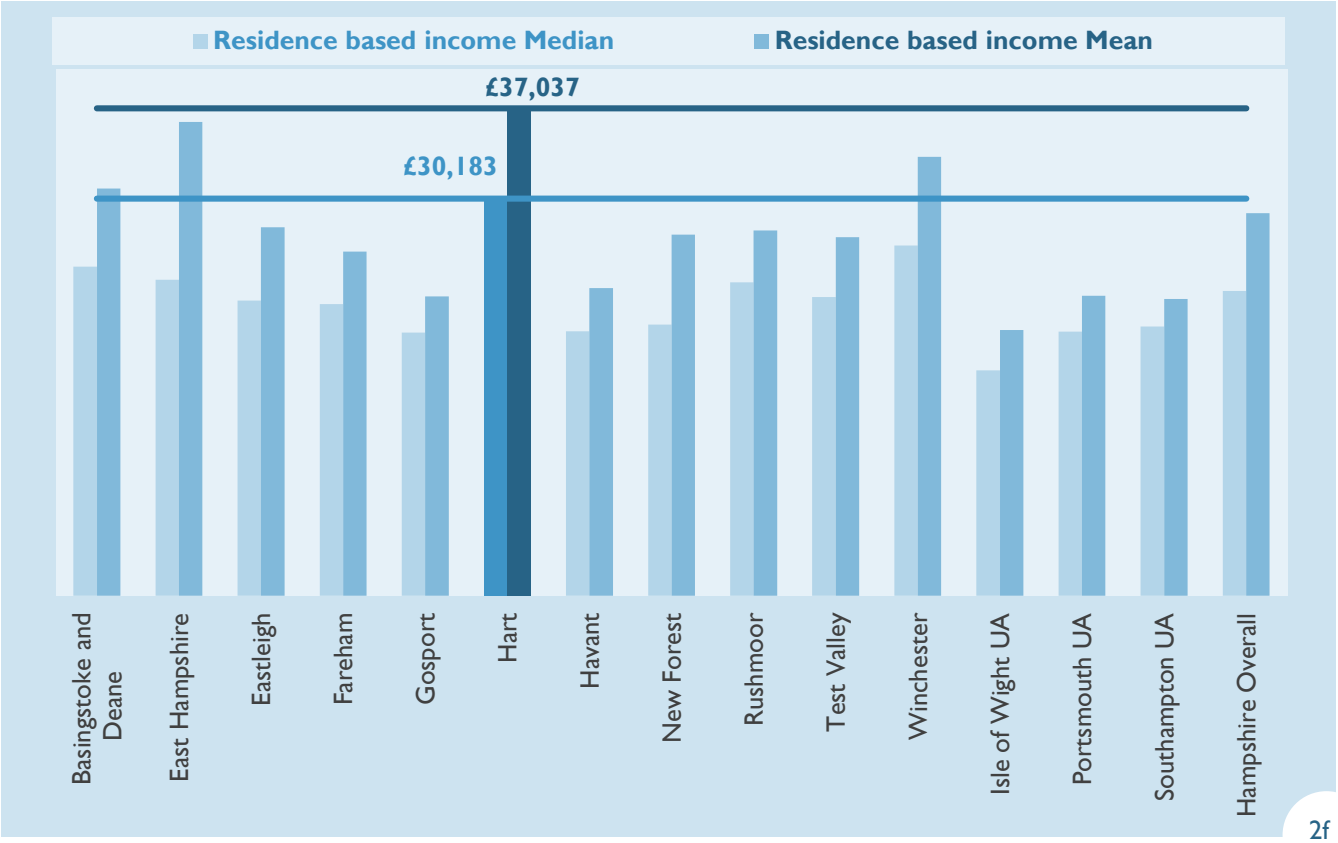
Work based income levels in Hampshire 2010



2e

Source: NOMIS / ONS annual survey of hours and earnings 2010

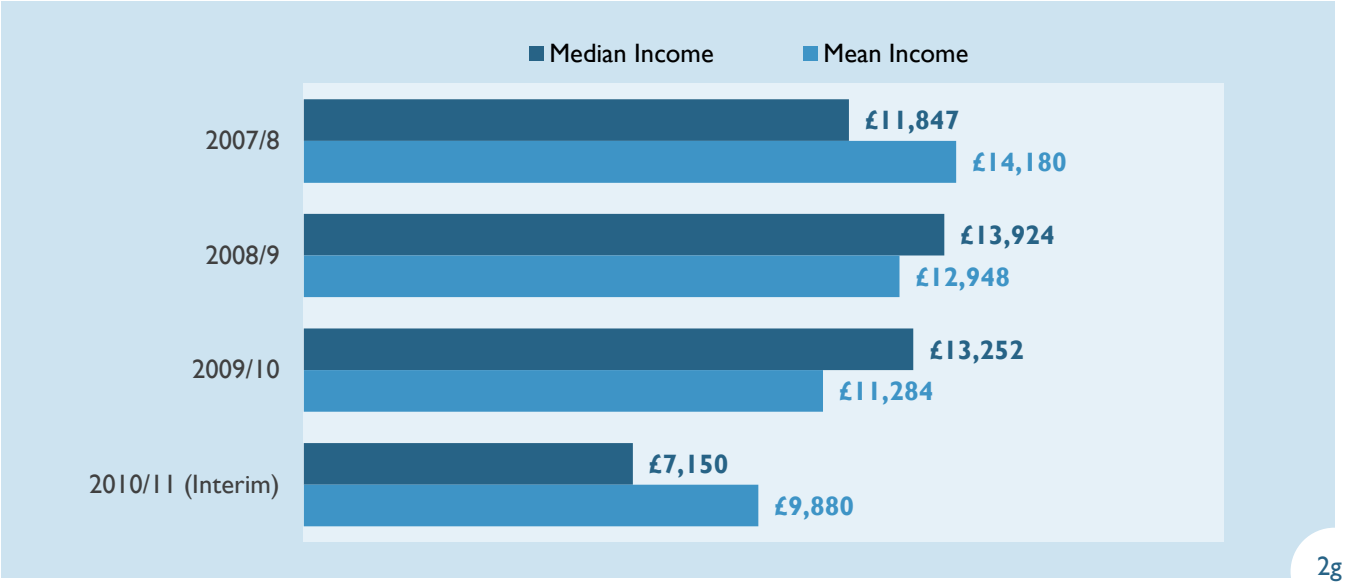
Residence based income levels in Hampshire 2010



2f

Source: NOMIS / ONS annual survey of hours and earnings 2010

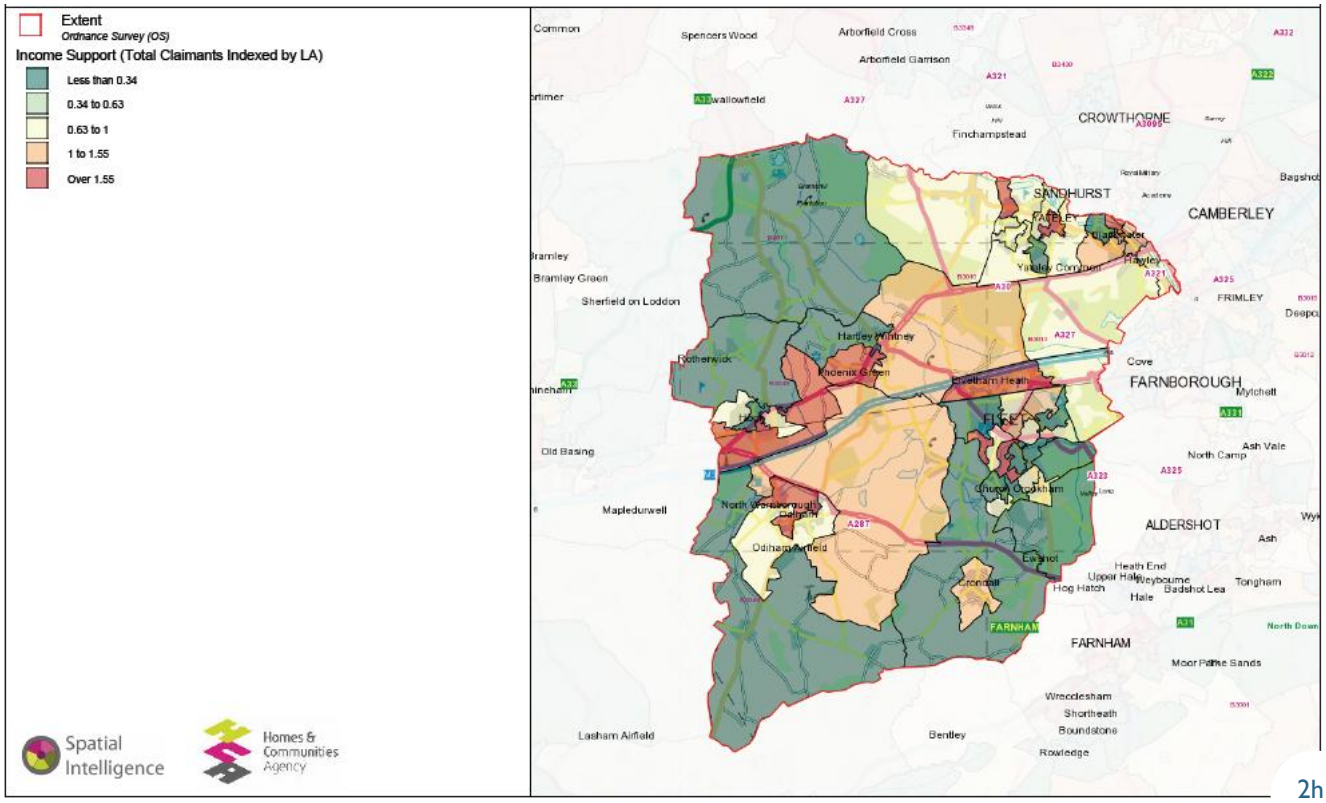
Income levels of new housing association tenants



2g

Source: CORE reports 2007 – 2011 *Note: 2010/11 uses an interim report that is based on a partial dataset. The final report due in September 2011 may provide a revised figure once the dataset is more complete.*

Income support in Hart by Lower Super Output Area



2h

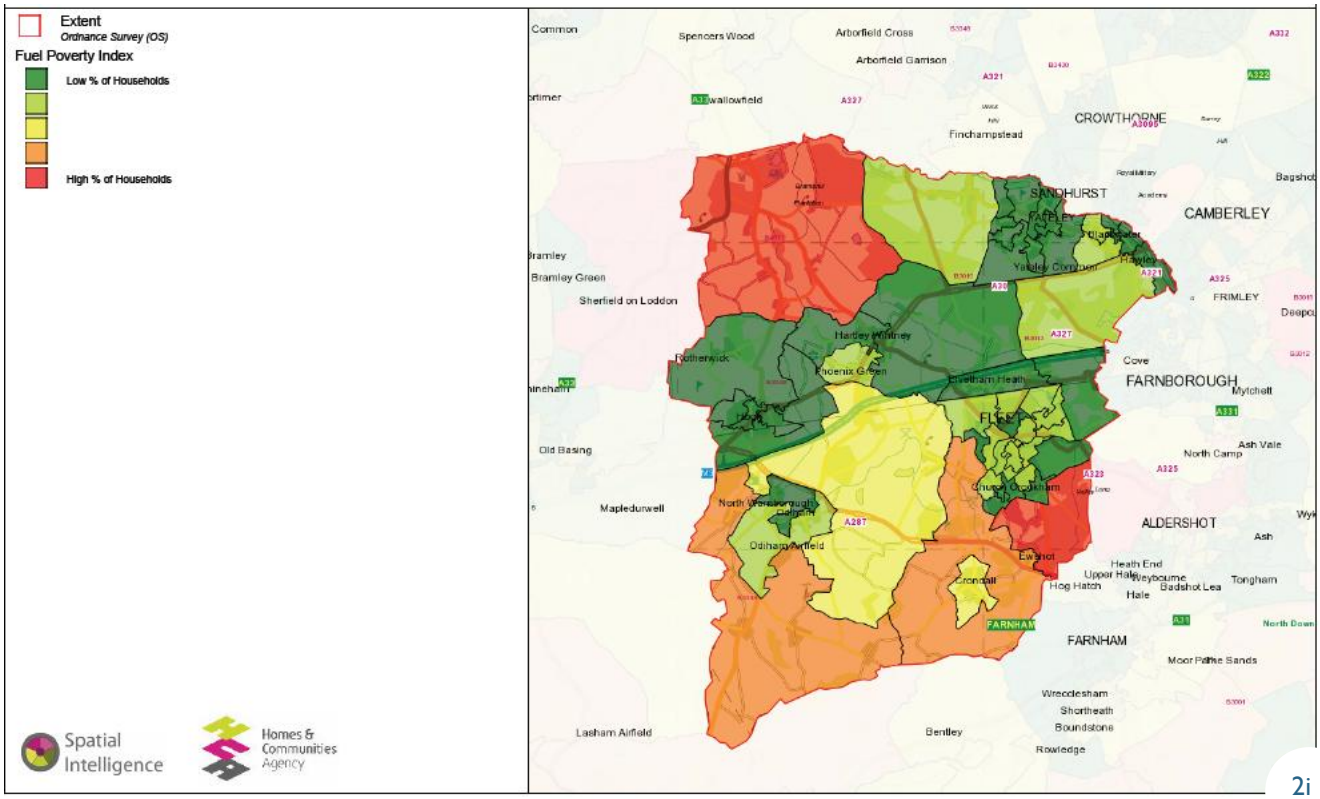
Source: Homes and Communities Agency 2011

2.4 Fuel poverty statistics for Hart

A household is considered to be in fuel poverty if more than 10% of their net household income is needed to be spent on energy to give an adequate provision of warmth and hot water. There are an estimated 2,700 (8.5%) dwellings in fuel poverty in Hart *(Source House Condition Survey 2010)* compared to approximately 13.2% based on the findings of the English House Condition Survey 2007, as reported in the Annual Report on Fuel Poverty Statistics 2009, published by the Department of Energy & Climate Change (DECC).

The charts below relating to the fuel poverty index are based on national standards (see inset in second chart for the detail) and again use lower super output areas to represent similar numbers of population per area.

Fuel Poverty Index in Hart by Lower Super Output Area

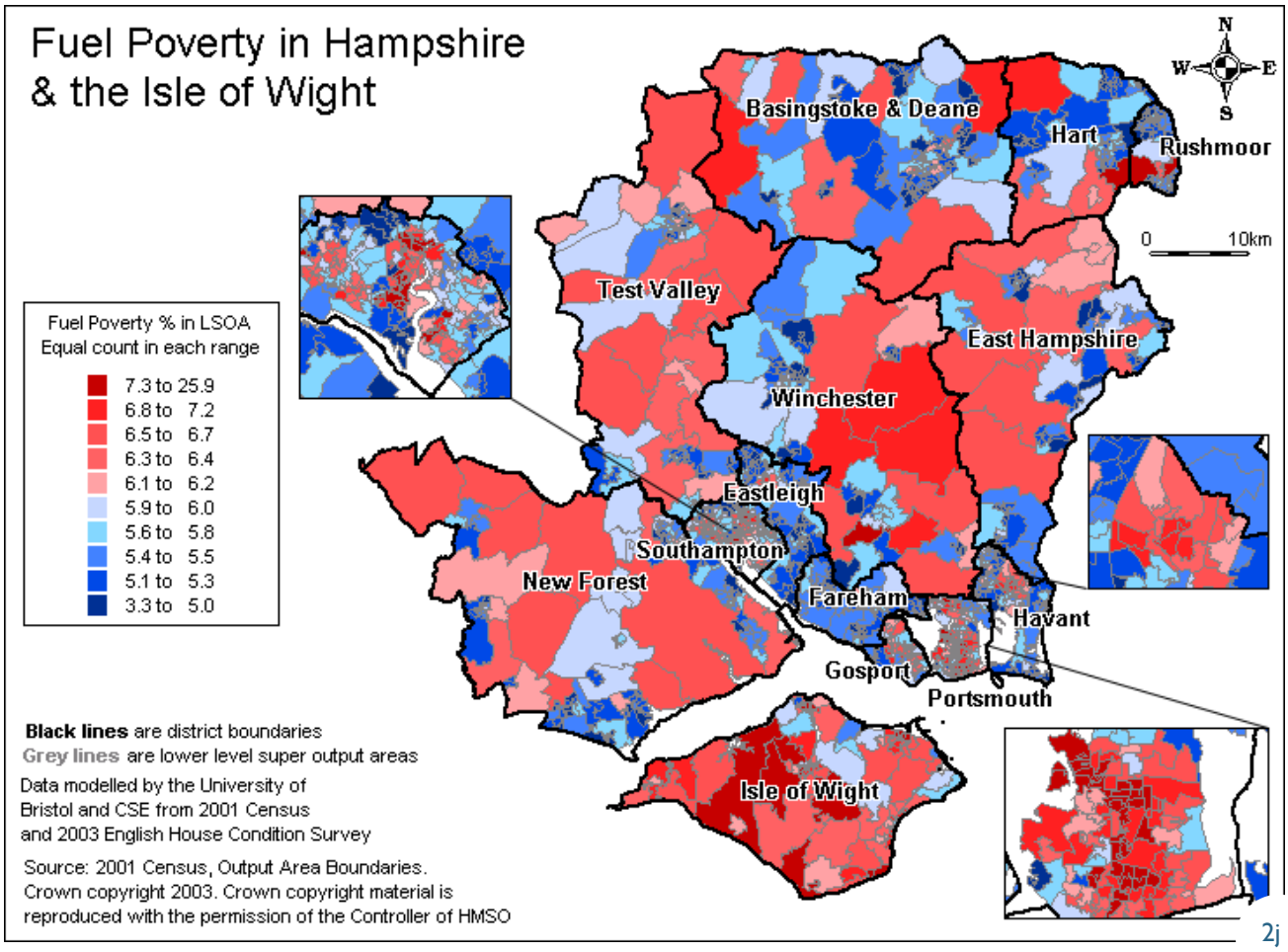


2i

Source: Homes and Communities Agency 2011

There appears to be no obvious correlation between distribution seen in the fuel poverty index (2i) and the income support (2h) maps for Hart, indeed some of the areas with the lowest levels of fuel poverty have the highest levels of income support claimants suggesting that fuel poverty in Hart is not linked to levels of income support claimants.

Fuel Poverty Index for Hampshire by Lower Super Output Area



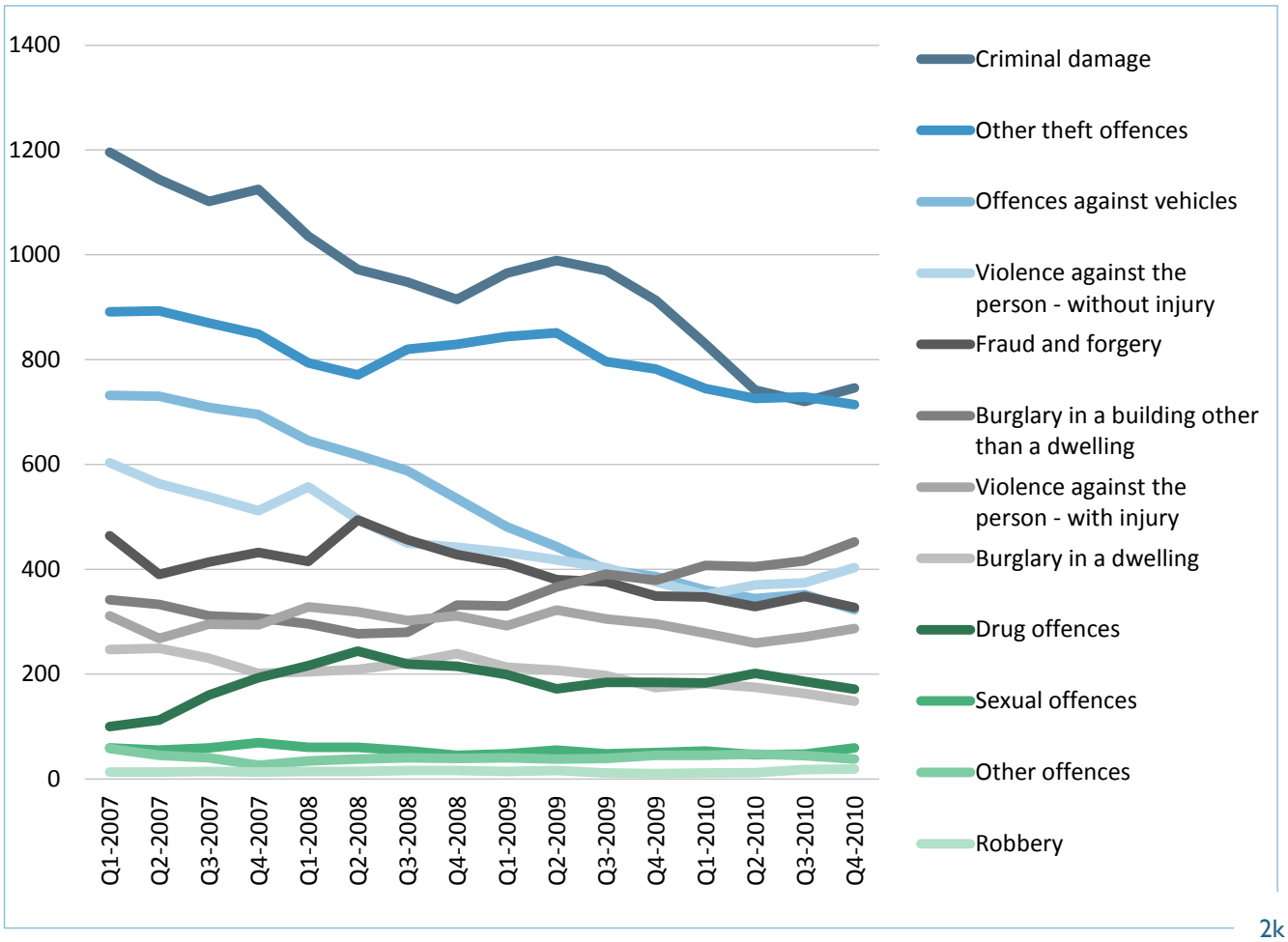
2j

Source: Centre for Sustainable Energy 2011

2.5 Local crime statistics for Hart

Whilst not initially appearing to be specifically related to housing, crime and the prevention of crime should be considered in housing related issues; to ensure that new developments, as well as refurbishments or improvements, are designed to minimise opportunities for crime and work in ensuring the management of existing housing stock is aligned to policing priorities. The Housing Options team can see clients who have been affected by or involved in crime and an understanding of the levels and type of crime. The Police have publicised their data (available at www.police.uk) down to street level potentially allowing for a greater examination of the relationship between housing and crime.

Crime Statistics for the district from 2007-2010



2k

Source: Home Office data 2011

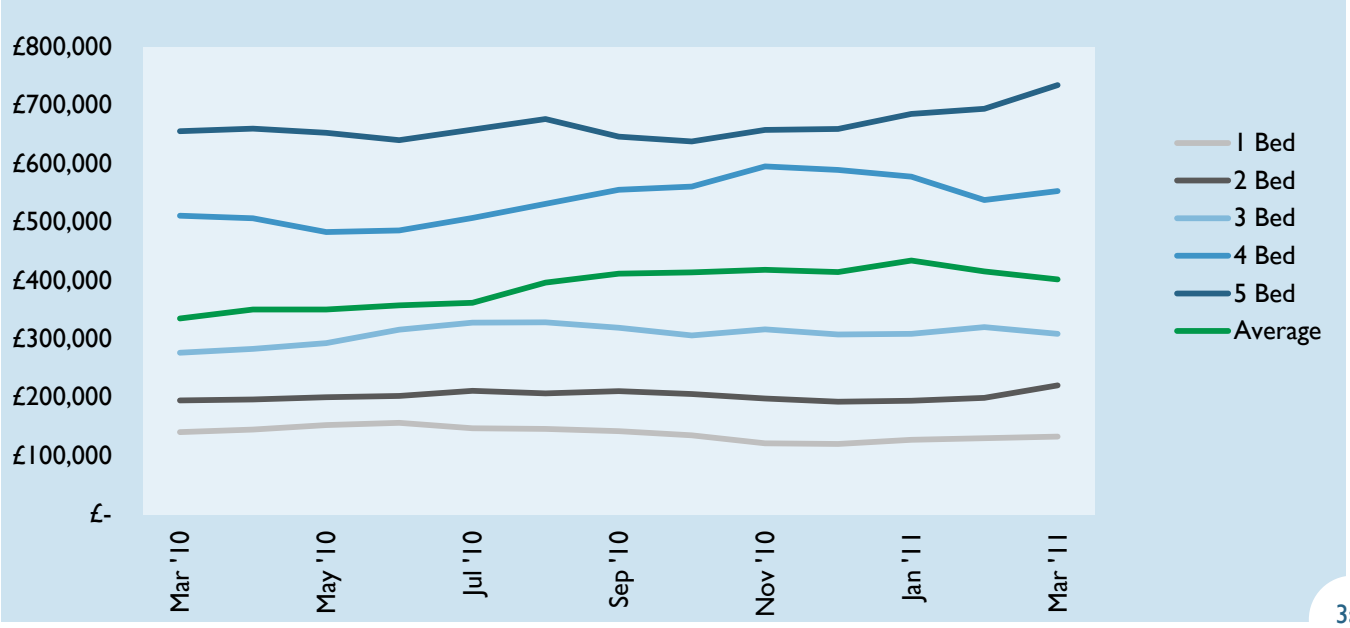
Section 3: **Affordability of housing in the district**

This section looks at the housing costs in Hart both for purchasing and renting. It also compares this with income levels to provide an indication of the relative level of affordability in the district.

3.1 Recent housing cost levels in Hart

The recent trends in the Hart area for housing costs show increases both in purchase and rental costs. The detail behind this however is more complicated and percentage changes become a less useful comparator when the number of transactions is low. The change in rental prices for larger accommodation is particularly dramatic although this again may be a result of such a small sample size.

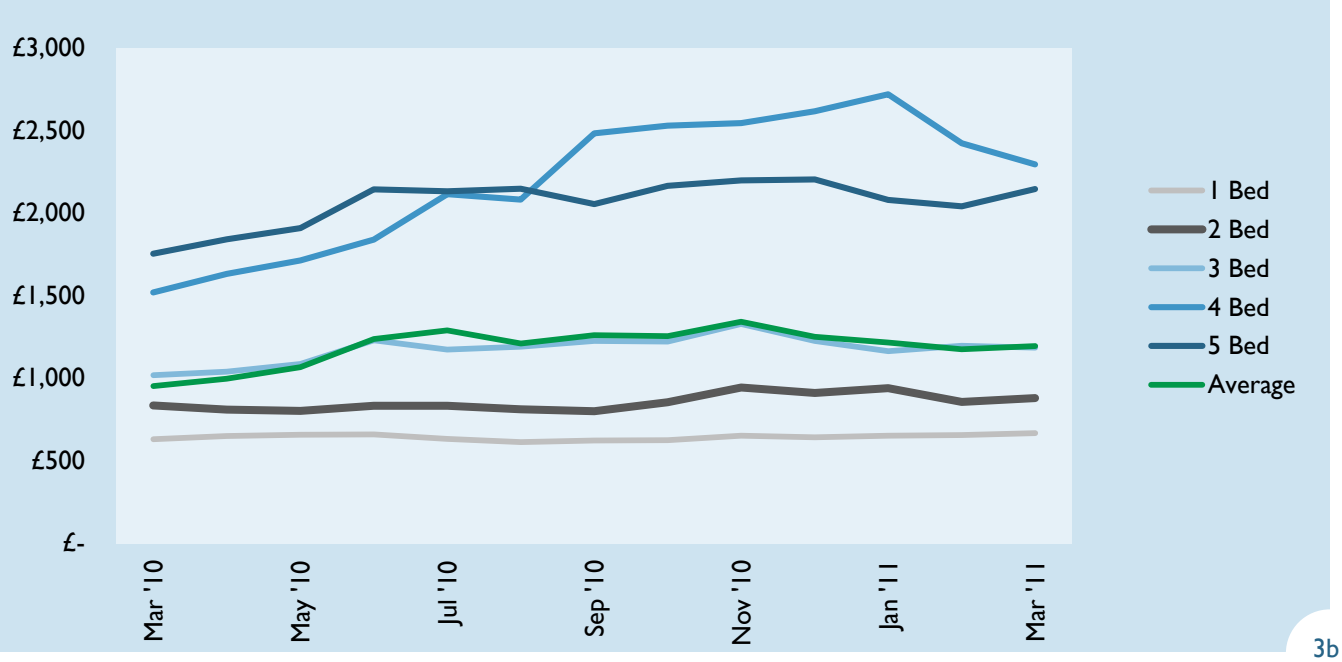
House purchase price trends March 2010 – March 2011



3a

Source: Nestoria 2011 (customised area based on 9.6km radius from centre of Hart)

House rental price trends March 2010 – March 2011



3b

Source: Nestoria 2011(customised area based on 9.6km radius from centre of Hart)

House prices in Hart as at March 2011

House Type	Price	Change in quarter*	Annual change	transactions
All	£362,250	+8.1%	+9.0%	210
Detached	£516,433	+3.7%	+15.9%	99
Flat	£159,412	-5.2%	+2.5%	24
Semi - Detached	£267,443	-0.1%	+4.4%	36
Terraced	£225,330	+1.2%	+2.8%	51

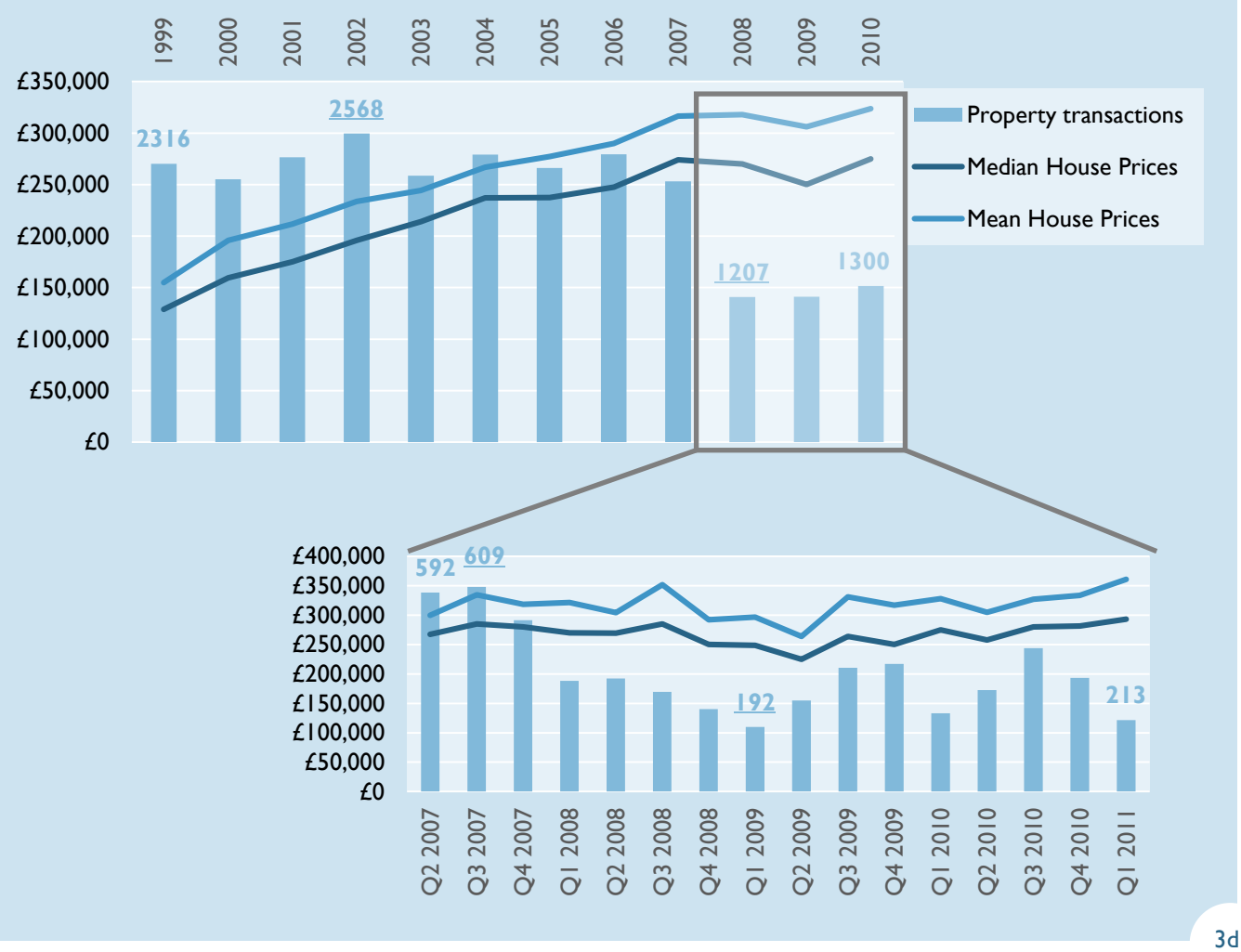
3c

Source: BBC (Land Registry of England and Wales, Crown copyright. The information above is based on figures provided by the Land Registry of England and Wales. Figures for England and Wales are for the period *January to March 2011.)

3.2 Longer term house price levels in Hart

The number of transactions remains about half of pre-2007 levels, which as referred to in section 3.1 means that percentage changes and average price levels can be misleading given the large change in sample size. However, the data shows that average house prices have risen beyond their 2007 levels.

House prices in Hart from 1999 to 2010



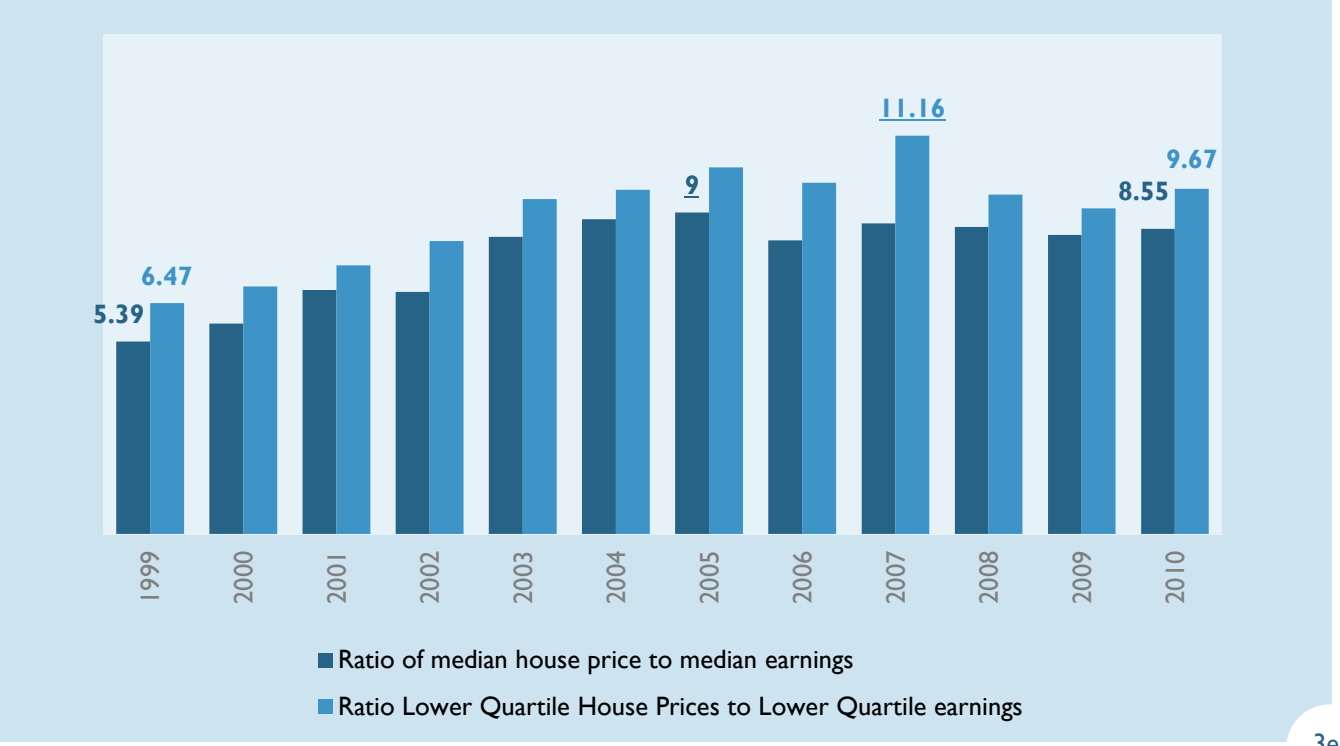
3d

Source: CLG live tables, Land Registry

3.3 Levels of affordability

Affordability can be a subjective term and as a result a number of different methods have been used to measure it. Affordability can be defined as the ability of households to access and sustain the costs of accommodation in an open market. The common benchmarks used are a 3 times multiple of gross annual income for purchase with a mortgage, and costs of 25-30% of annual income for renting. Another way of assessing the relative affordability of housing for a population or area is to compare the ratio of house prices to incomes. This generates a single value (a ratio of house price to earnings) that be compared over time. For Hart, house prices increases in the last 10 years have outstripped increases in income levels in the district resulting in a worsening of the ratio of house price to earnings. As can be seen in chart (3e), the ratio has fallen slightly from its peaks in 2005 and 2007, for median and lower quartile comparisons respectively, but they are still higher than in 7 and 9 of the 11 years shown respectively.

Ratio of house price to earnings in Hart from 1999 – 2010

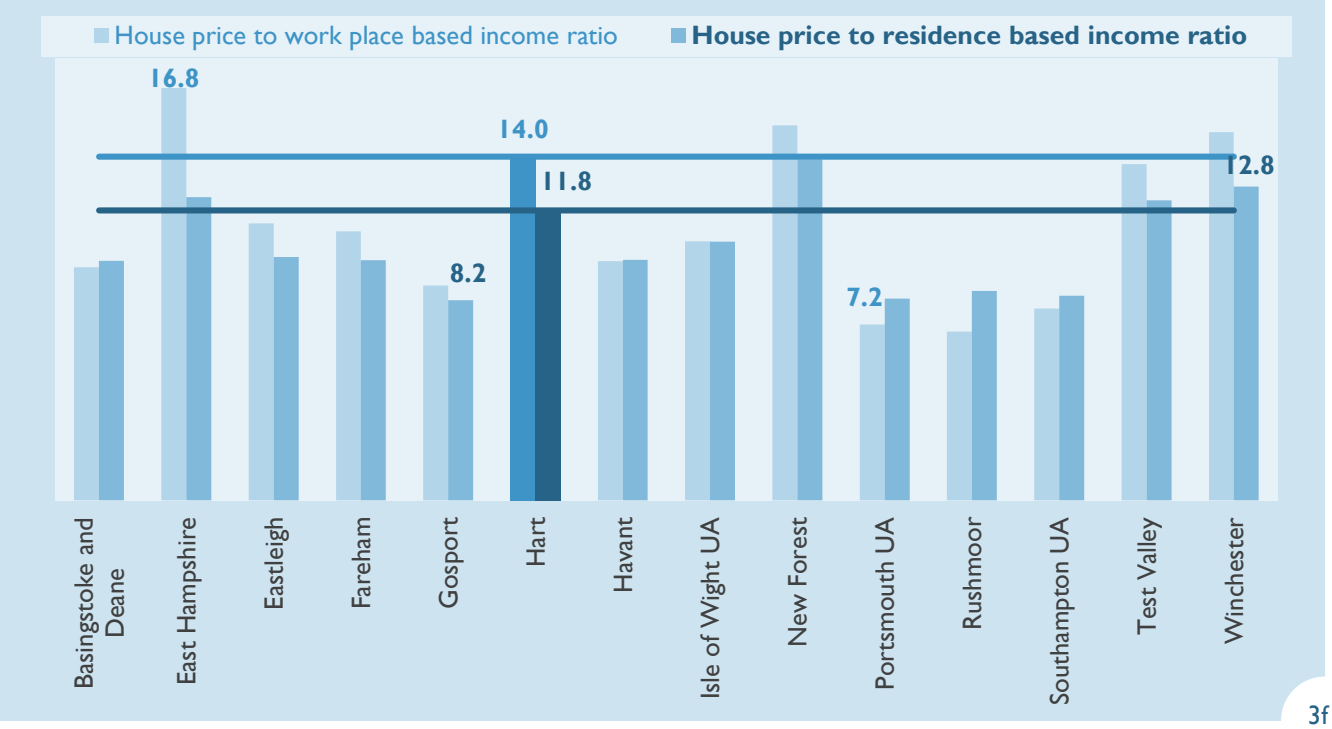


3e

Source: CLG live tables, Land Registry

Another way to consider local affordability is to compare work place based income levels (which measures the average income earned by people employed in the area) and residence based income levels (which measures the average income earned by people residing, but not necessarily employed in the area). This can highlight a difference in live - work affordability levels.

Ratio of house price to earnings (work place based and residence based) in Hampshire



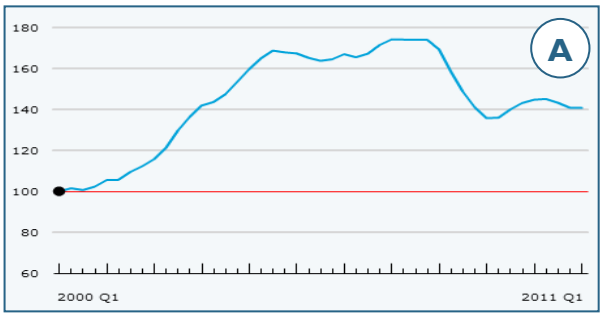
3f

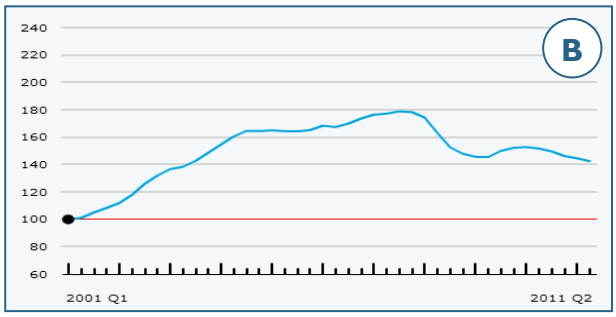
Source: National Housing Federation 2011 (based on data from 2009)

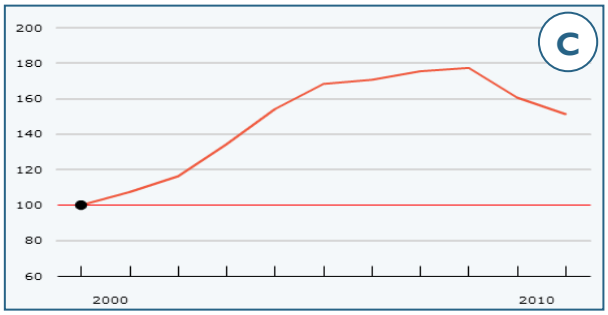
3.4 Broader indicators of affordability

Another way to look at the wider indication of changes in the levels of affordability over time is to look at index rated change (i.e. the percentage change from a base date – in the charts below quarter 1 2000). These all show that whilst costs are lower than their peak for Britain as a whole (as seen above, Hart does not necessarily follow this trend) prices remain less affordable than the early 2000s.

Indexed indicators of housing affordability in Britain







A. Prices against rents – compares the relationship between the costs of buying and renting. The ratio of prices against rents has increased ~40% over the time period.

B. Prices in real terms – price changes adjusted by consumer prices to account for inflation. In this case house prices have increased ~40% in real terms over the time period.

C. Prices against average income – compares house prices against average incomes. The ratio of prices against rents has increased ~50% over the time period.

3g

Source: The Economist house-price indicators, Nationwide, Office for National Statistics – all charts have their index base set at 100 as at Quarter 1 2000

Section 4: **Profile of Hart's Housing Register**

This section covers the Housing Register held by Hart District Council. It provides information on overall numbers as well as a profile of these households and relative levels of housing need.

4.1 Number of households on the Housing Register

As at the 31st of March 2011 there were:

2,019 applicants on the register (including those suspended)

of which **169** were transfer applicants

and **92** were wanting older persons housing

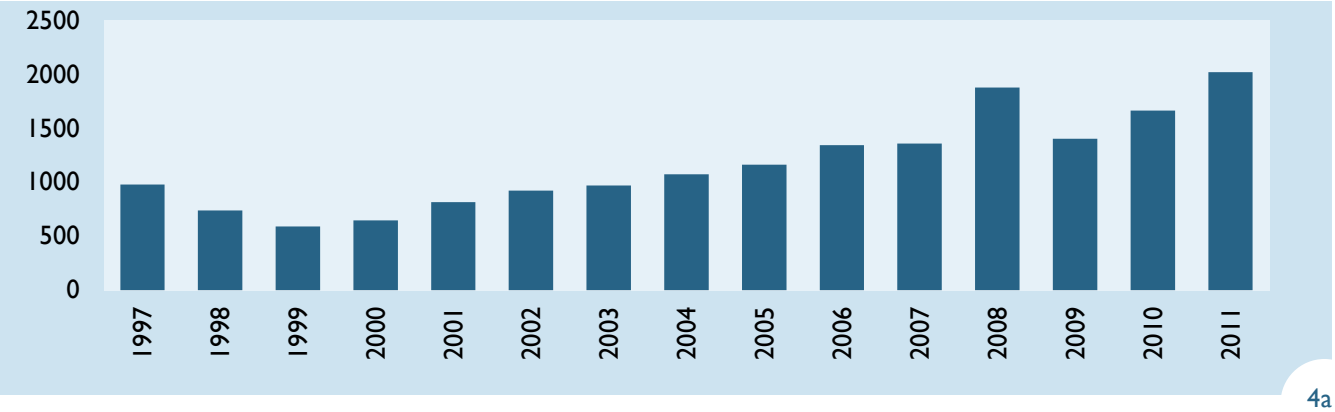
1,392

The number of households active on the Housing Register - as at 31st of March 2011

The Housing Register, which is one indicator of housing need, by its nature fluctuates on a daily basis, as people's situations change. The degree to which this is true can be seen in the 'turnover' on the register. The renewal process tries to ensure that the register reflects, as accurately as possible, the number of households in housing need at a given time. However it can have the effect of distorting the total number on the register.

Of the figures shown above, **627** of the applicants were suspended; this is mainly due to failure to provide identification with their application. A number of these applicants will be in housing need and will wish to remain on the list but feel their chances are low and have little incentive to keep their application up-to date, whilst a number will go on to pursue other options. It is felt that whilst the suspended applicants' number can inflate the total and cause fluctuations, it is important not to lose this information on housing need.

Number of applicants on the Hart Housing Register from April 1997 to April 2011



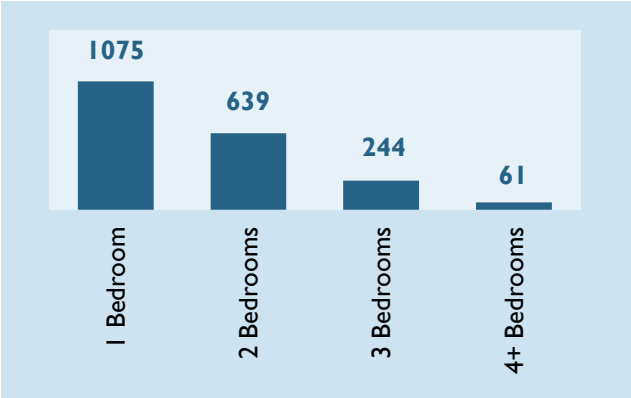
4a

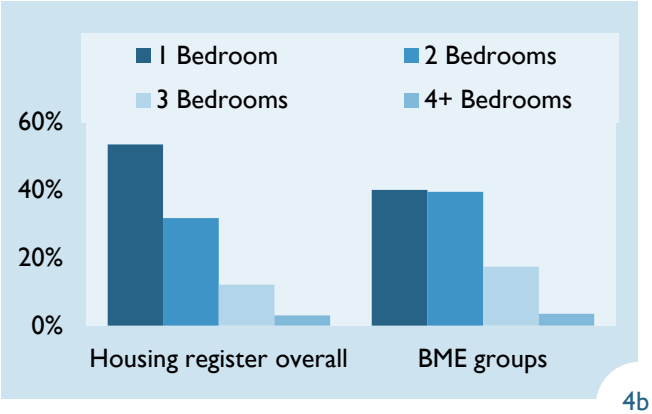
Source: Hart Housing Register

4.2 Profile of those on the Housing Register

As has been the case historically, a large proportion of the Housing Register is in need of one bedroom accommodation. Of the 2019 households register on the 31st of March 2011; 53% were in need of one bedroom accommodation, 32% for two bedrooms, 12% for three bedrooms and 3% for four or more bedrooms. The housing need by number of bedrooms needed by Black and Minority Ethnic (BME) groups compared to the housing register as a whole is slightly more evenly distributed between one, two and three bed properties.

Housing Register applicants by number of bedrooms needed (31st March 2011) and Black and Minority Ethnic (BME) Housing Register applicants by number of bedrooms needed as at 31st March 2011

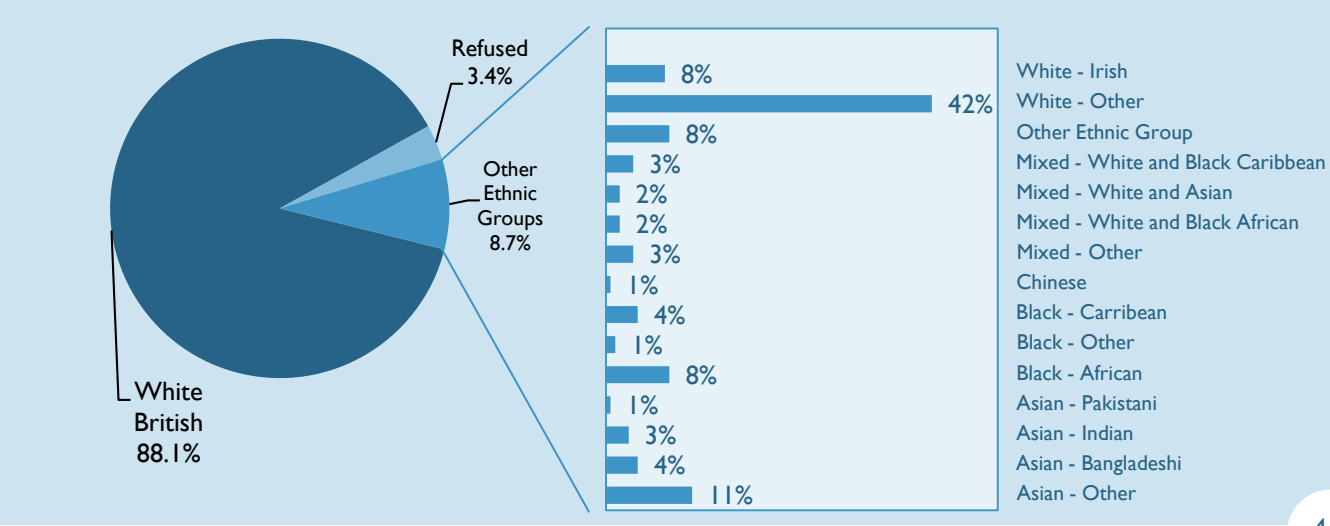




4b

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011)

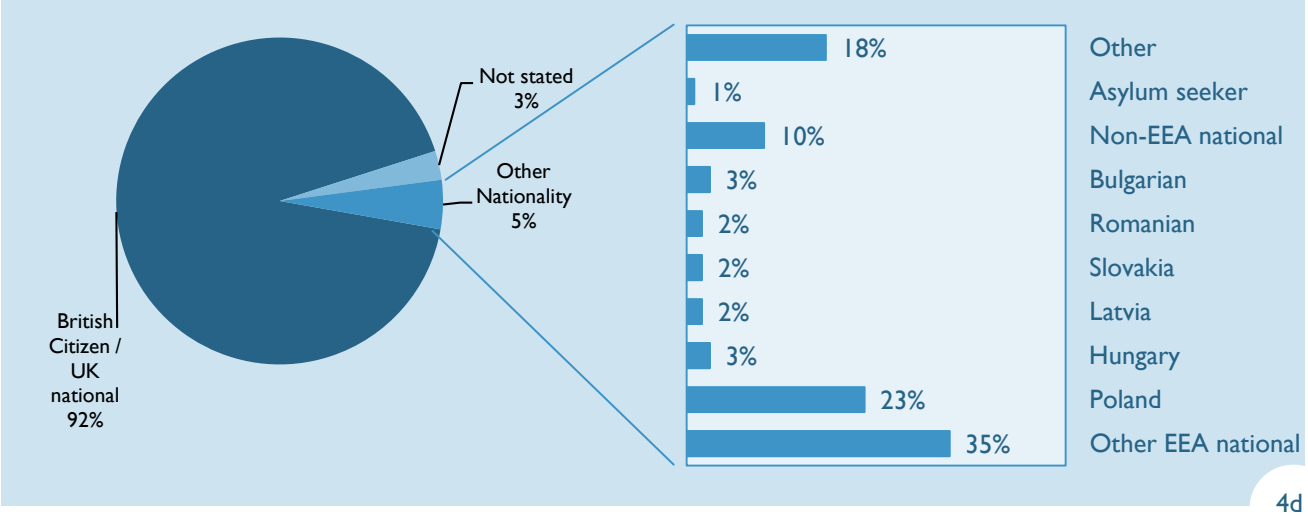
Households on the Housing Register by ethnic group as at 31st March 2011



4c

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011)

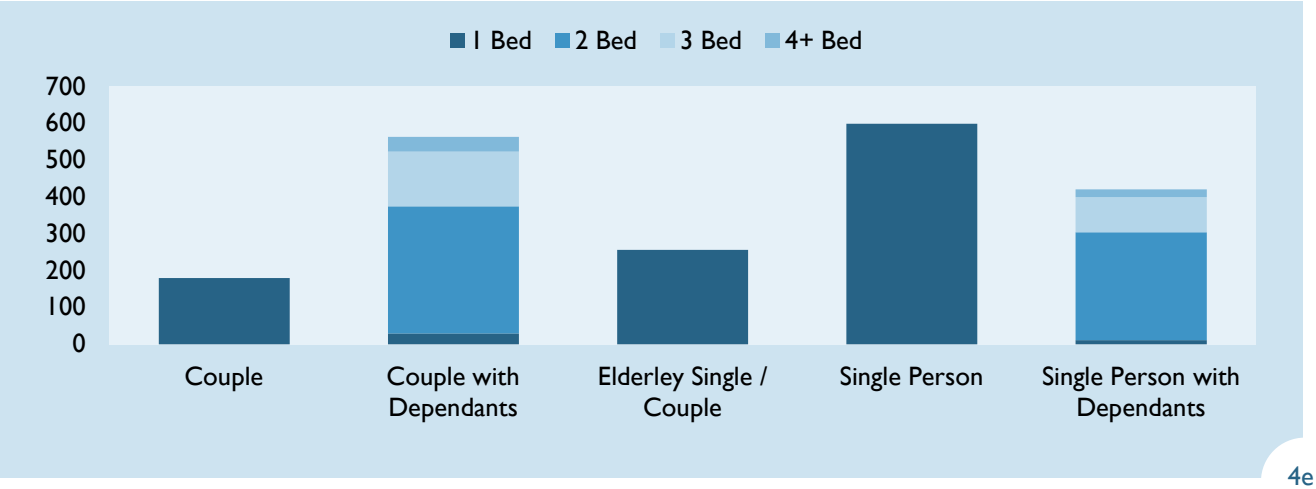
Housing Register applicants by nationality as at 31st March 2011



4d

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011)

Housing Register applicants by household type and number of bedrooms needed as at 31st March 2011

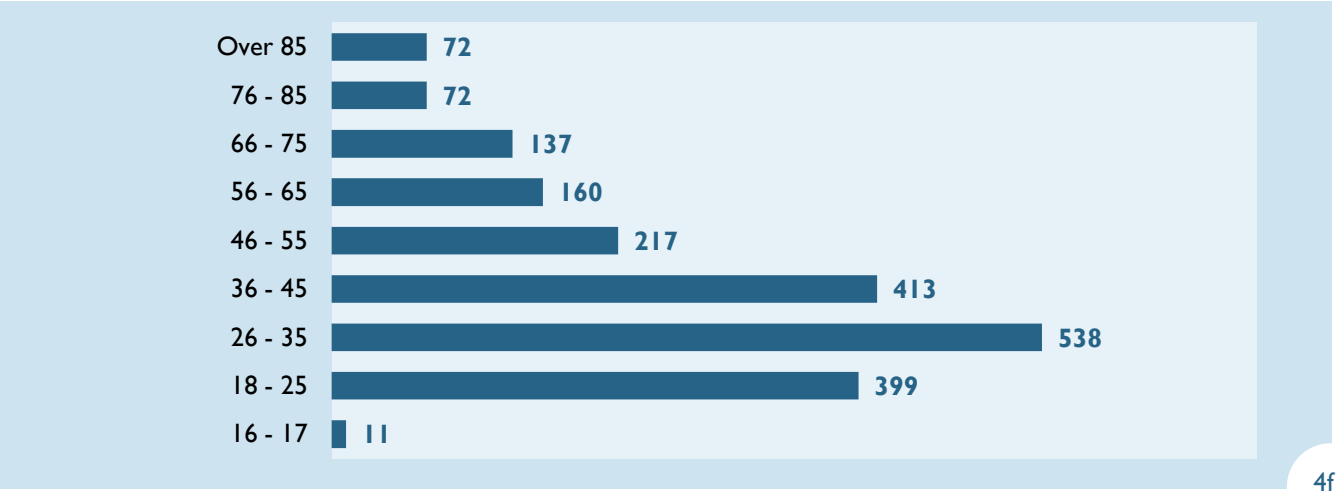


4e

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011)

Possibly reflecting the house price increases since 2000, and the worsening of the affordability ratio seen in section 4; over two thirds of those on the housing register are aged 45 and under (47% are aged 35 and under, 67% are aged 45 and under). These people are likely to have missed out on being able to purchase on the open market when affordability ratios were lower.

Profile of applications by age of eldest household member on the Housing Register as at 31st March 2011



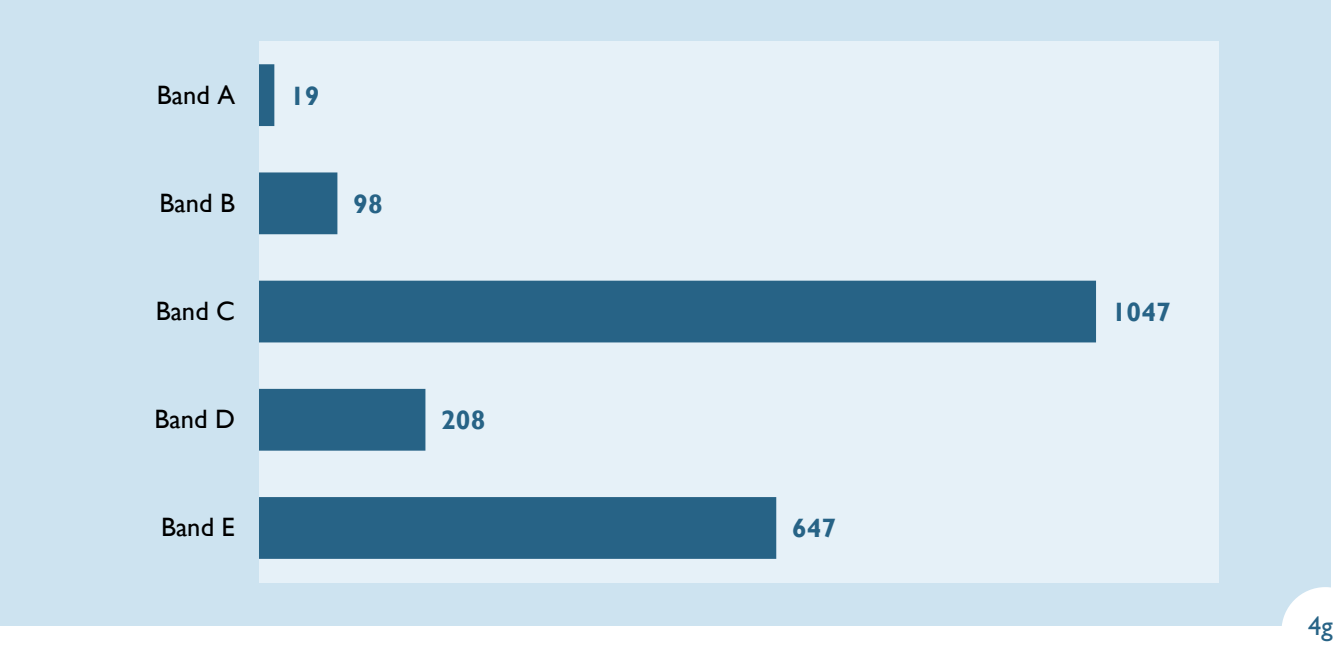
4f

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011)

4.3 Housing need levels on the Housing Register

Whilst overall numbers of those on the housing register are useful in understanding the level of demand for affordable housing, it does not take into account the differing levels of housing need experienced by those on the register. The way in which the Council prioritises applicants for the limited resource of affordable housing in the district is by grouping applicants into 'bands' that reflect levels of need and then by waiting time. This is considered the fairest and simplest way in which the Council can operate its allocations policy. Below provides information on the numbers of household in each need level.

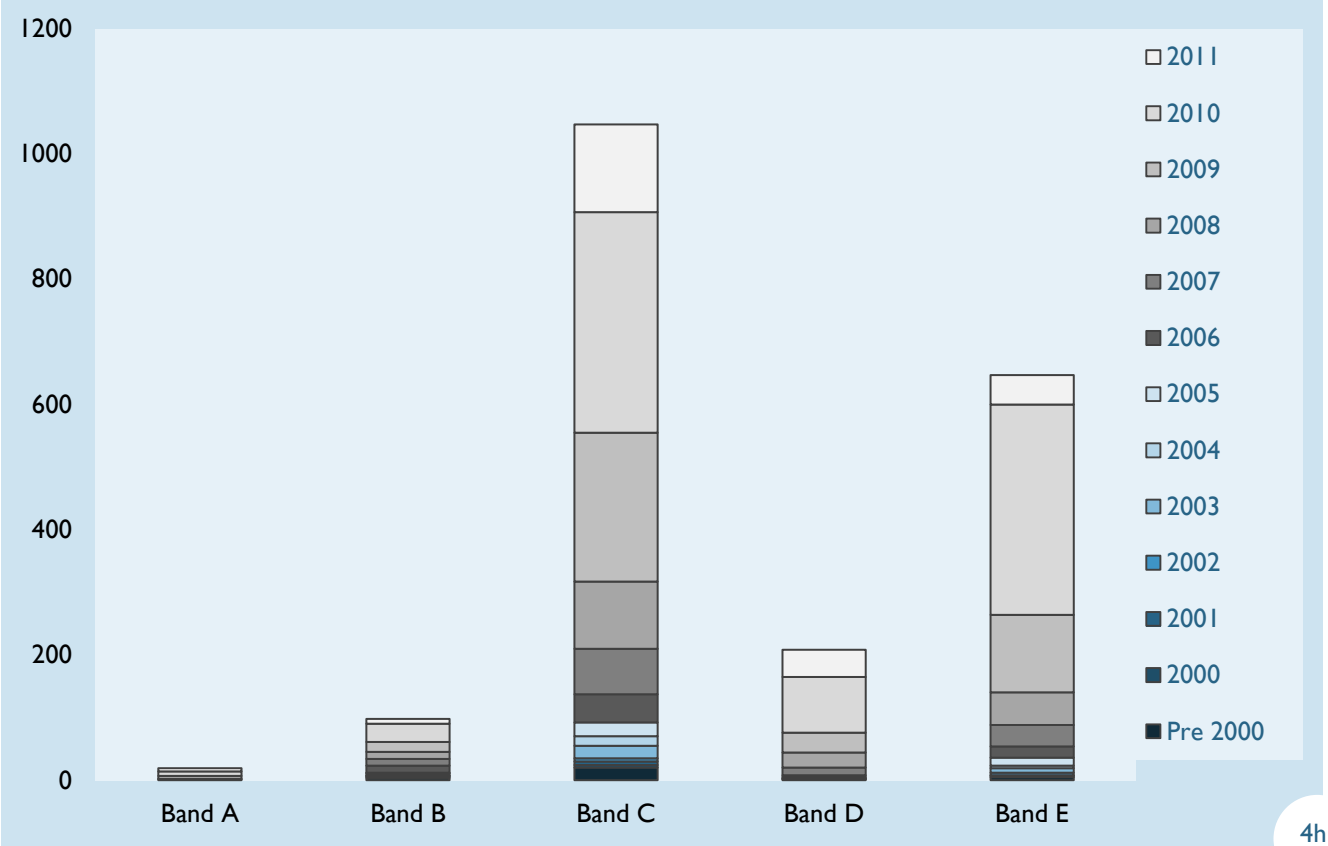
Housing Register households by priority band



4g

Source: Hart Housing Register (as at 31st March 2011)

Housing Register households by priority band and the effective date they joined the register



4h

Source: Hart Housing Register (as at 31st March 2011)

Section 5: **Housing association lettings in Hart**

This section provides information on the allocation of affordable rented housing in the district, both the number of lets and the profile of households successful in applying for these properties.

5.1 Trends in Housing Register lettings

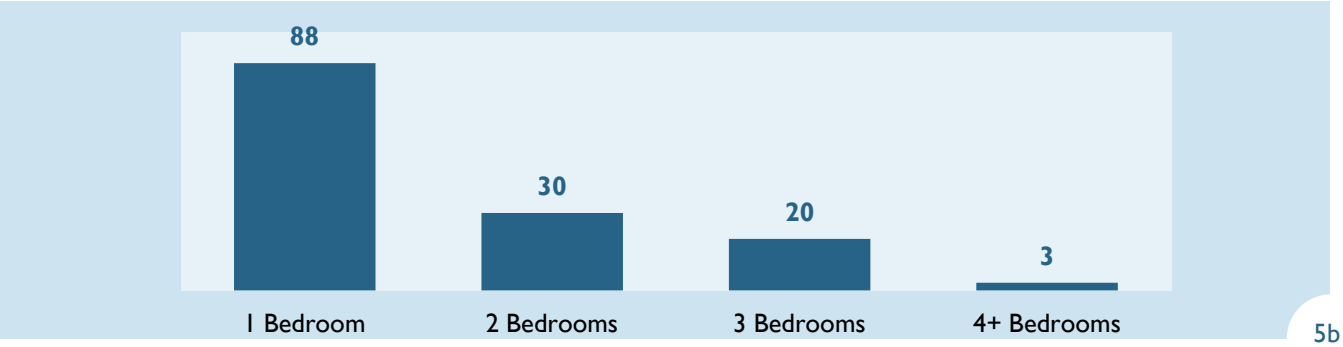
The number of lets has been fairly consistent over the last 10 years despite a fluctuation in the number of new build properties (although it should also be noted that the new build shared ownership properties do not create additional lets). In years where there has been little new build delivery the number of re-lets has helped to ensure that a supply of housing has been available to households. The high number of 1 bedroom properties let in 2010-11 is partly a reflection of the stock composition (seen in section 1) and partly the higher turnover associated with growing families and older people. Housing Associations that have nominations agreements in place with the Council have the discretion for up to 10% of their stock to be allocated by themselves directly; this can be seen in the different total found in table (5c) to the corresponding year in chart (5a).

Number of properties let each year through Hart District Council's allocation system

5a

Source: Hart Housing Register

Number of properties let in 2010-11 by number of bedrooms through Hart District Council's allocation system



5b

Source: Hart Housing Register

Number of properties let in 2010-11 by Housing Associations in Hart

English Rural	Hanover	Hyde	Sentinel	Thames Valley	Total
1	16	2	123	14	156

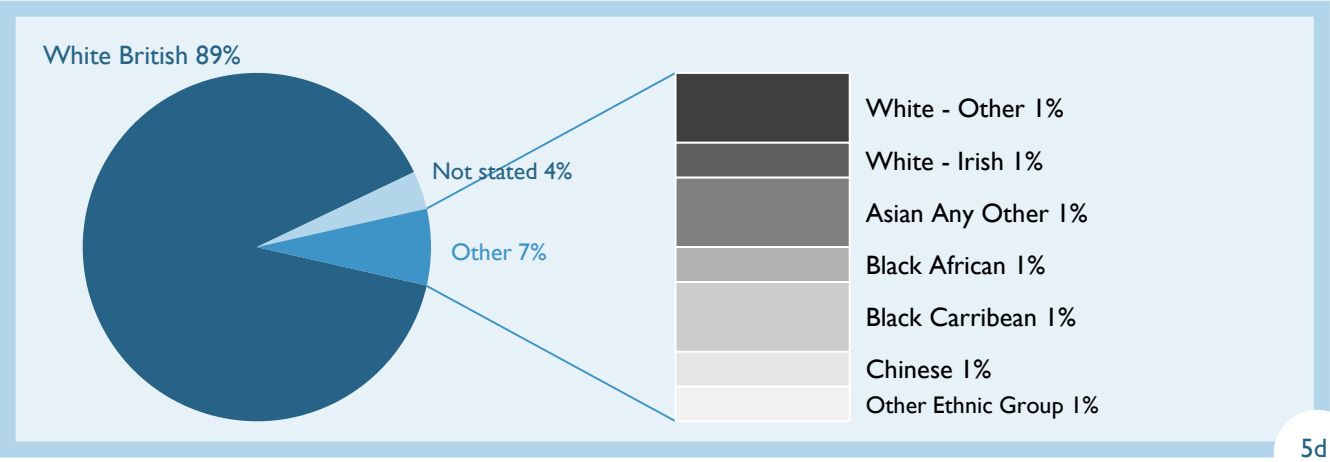
5c

Source: CORE 2011

5.2 Profile of households let properties through the Housing Register

As can be seen below, the profile of households who have been successful in applying for affordable housing in 2010-11 does not differ much in terms of the ethnic origin, although both the age and household type profiles differ from that of the profile of the housing register overall. This is likely to be due to the type of properties that became available for re-let over the period.

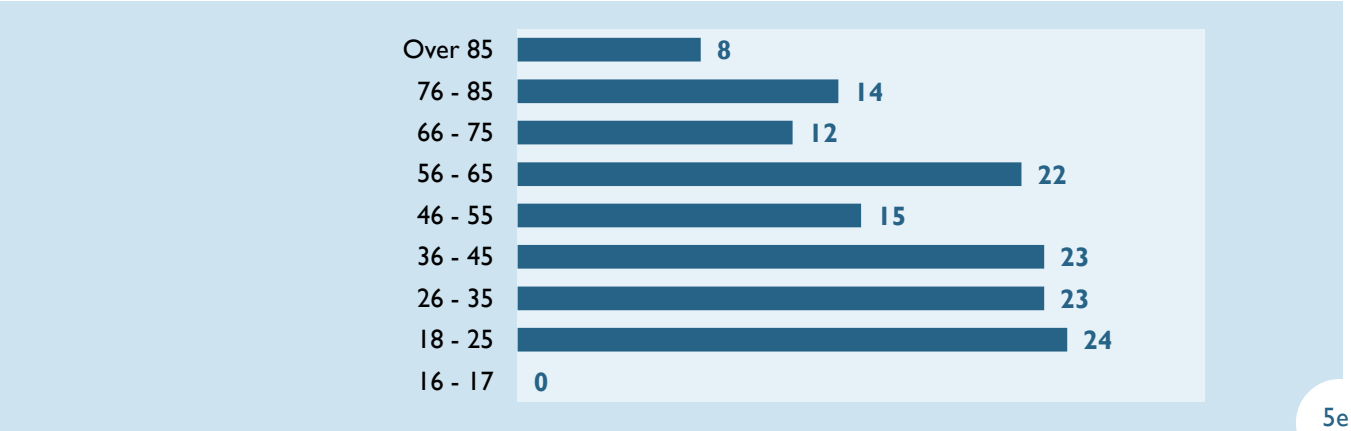
Ethnicity profile of successful applicants in 2010-11



5d

Source: Hart Housing Register

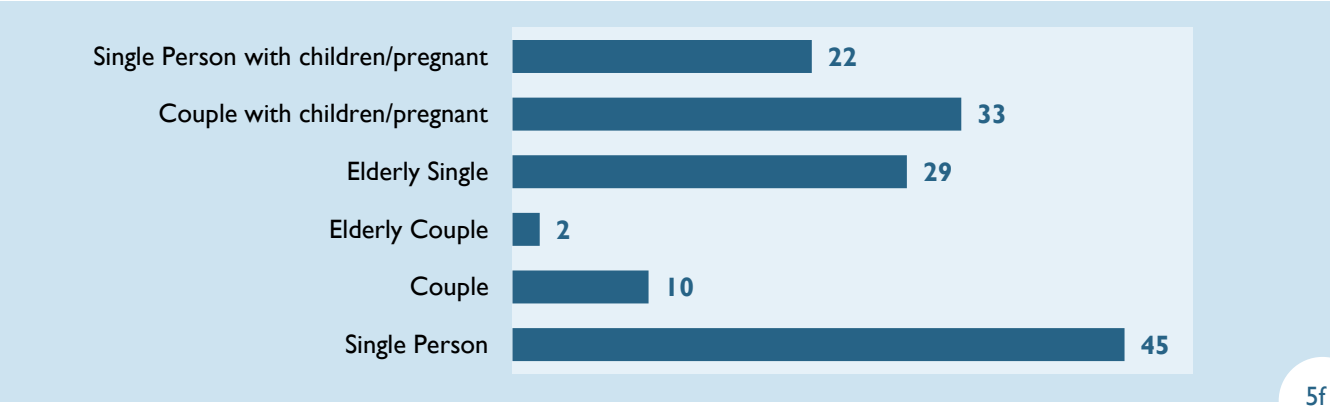
Age profile of successful applicants in 2010-11



5e

Source: Hart Housing Register

Household profile of successful applicants in 2010-11



5f

Source: Hart Housing Register

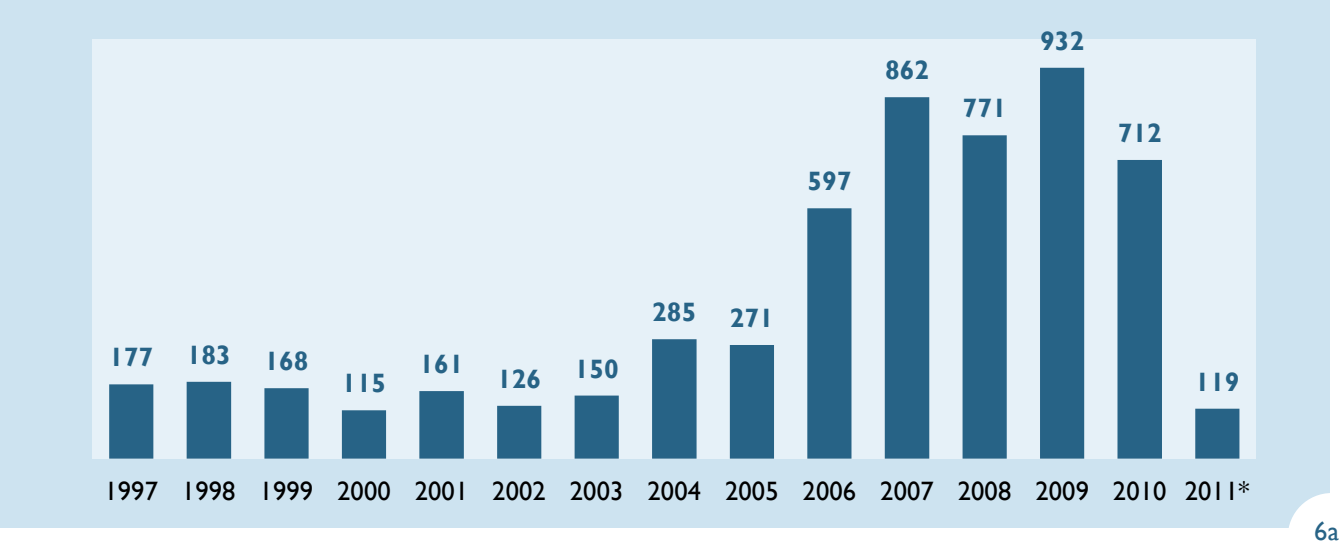
Section 6: **Housing advice and prevention of homelessness**

This section focuses on the housing advice service provided by Hart District Council. It provides information on the number of households seen, most common reasons for approaching the Council for advice and the casework done by officers to prevent homelessness.

6.1 Homeless approaches in Hart

The housing advice service sees a number of applicants each year, the sudden increase, since 2006 is likely to be as a result of better monitoring of workloads (although the cases seen can include repeat approaches of the same case). Work is being undertaken to look at the way in which this information can be captured efficiently and in a way that better reflects the number of cases dealt with each year. The 5 most common reasons for approaching the service since 2007 shows a significant rise in the number of mortgage arrears cases seen, these are often more complex cases for officers to deal with and so have an impact on the service's resources.

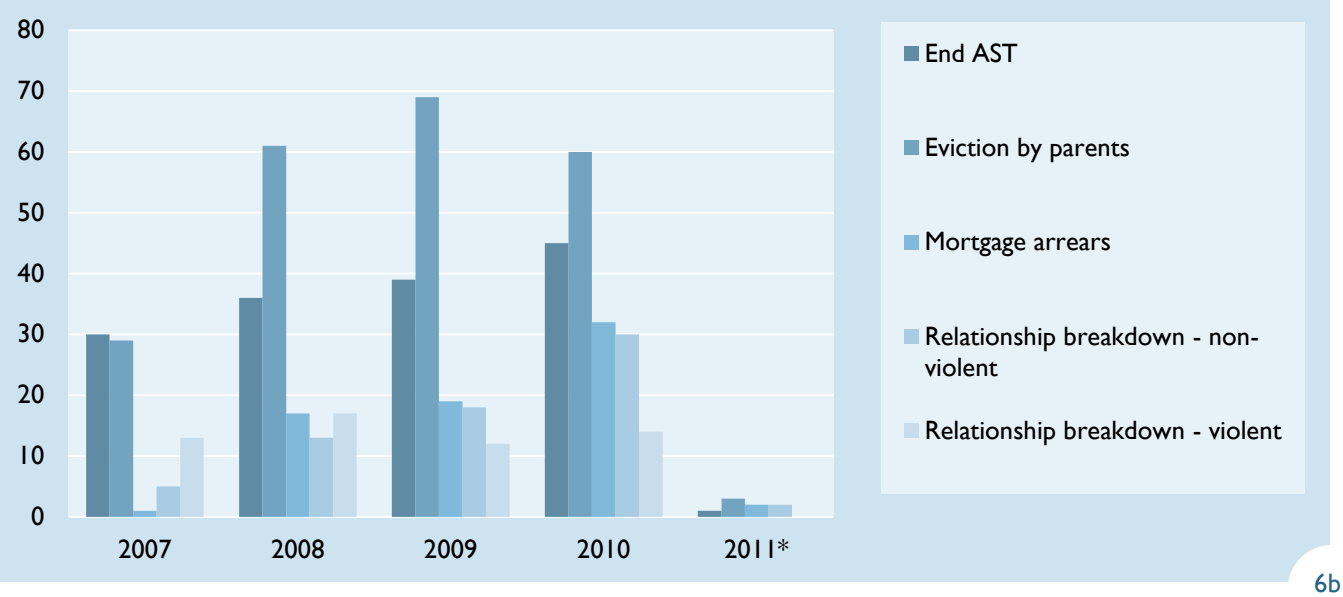
Number of homelessness approaches 1997 – 2011



6a

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011) *year to 31st March

5 most common reasons for homelessness approaches 2007 – 2011 March



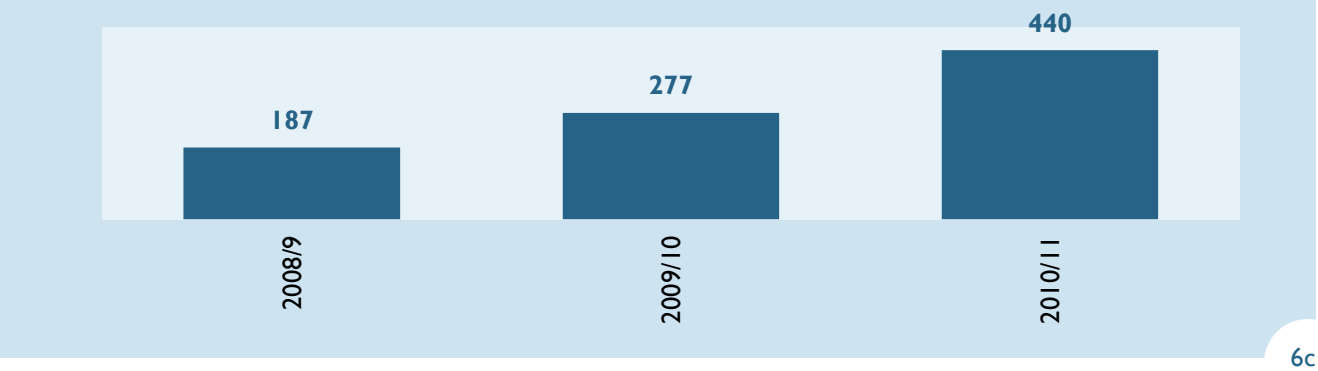
6b

Source: Hart Housing Register (March 2011) *year to 31st March

6.2 Prevention of homeless casework in Hart

A more important indicator than homelessness approaches is the outcomes the advice service produces in terms of preventing homelessness. This is covered below and shows the number of successful homelessness preventions and the types of housing options that achieved this outcome. The large use of 'other' (82) in *Prevention - Enabled household to remain in their home* is an issue for reporting. The commentary behind these cases suggests that most were looking for alternative accommodation but were not necessarily facing homelessness. Advice was offered to these households on the options that would be available to them and the household decided that they would prefer to remain where they are currently.

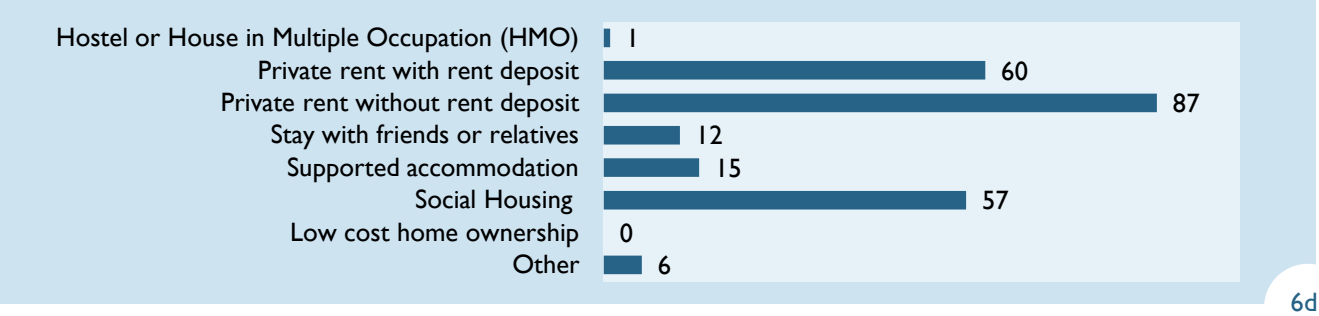
Number of households prevented from homelessness annually



6c

Source: Hart P1E returns

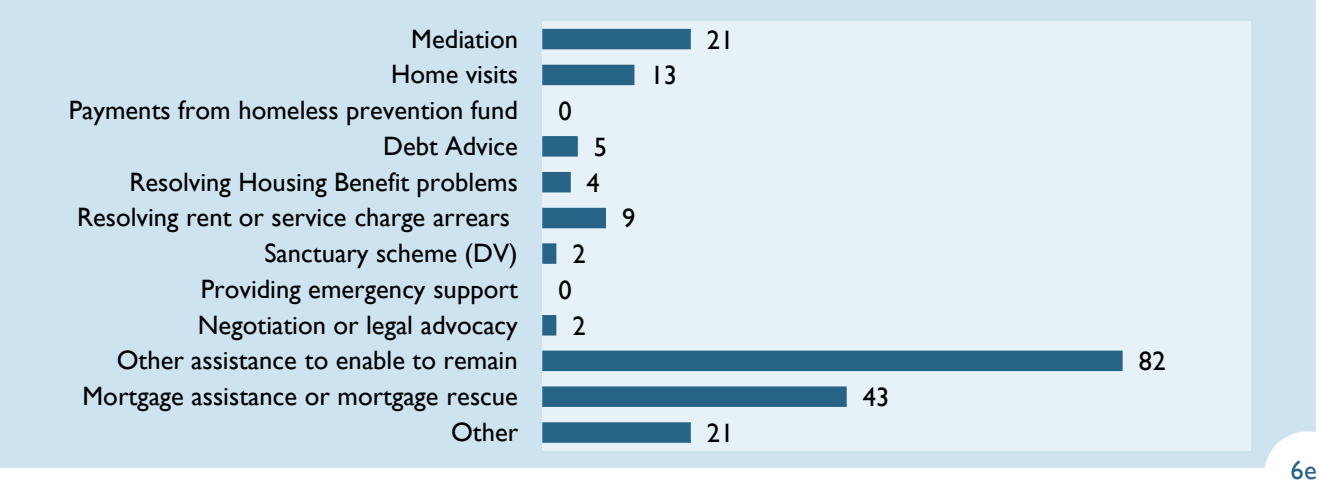
Prevention - Household assisted to obtain alternative accommodation



6d

Source: Hart P1E returns

Prevention - Enabled household to remain in their home



6e

Source: Hart P1E returns